Whose Body Is it?
Sport and the Problem of Autonomy



Thirteenth International Conference on Sport & Society

Aarhus University Aarhus, Denmark

30 June-1 July 2022

AARHUS UNIVERSITY

The Thirteenth International Conference on Sport & Society

https://sportandsociety.com/about/history/2022-conference

First published in 2023 in Champaign, Illinois, USA
by Common Ground Research Networks, NFP
www.cgnetworks.org
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Edited by Jörg Kreiger

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PDF ISBN: 978-1-957792-58-3

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Welcome Letters

AARHUS UNIVERSITY

Dear Conference Delegates,

It is with great pleasure to welcome you all to the 2022 Sport & Society Conference at Aarhus University and online. This will be the first Sport & Society Conference with the possibility to attend on-site since 2019 and I am extremely grateful that we can host the conference in Denmark this year. It is time that we socialize and engage in-person again and I look forward to seeing many familiar faces without having to look into a computer screen.

This year's special conference focus is "Whose Body Is It? The Problem of Autonomy in Sport," a theme that could not be more relevant now. The political and public debates over mandatory vaccinations have triggered many people to think about body rights. It has become clear that humans are not the only noes trying to control their own bodies, but politicians, business, and social groups also have an interest in bodies. As a result, other stakeholders than ourselves profoundly influence the meaning of "our" bodies via defining the limits of what, where, and how we can use them. In response, bodily autonomy movements have gained significant popularity, also due to Black Lives Matter and the disability movement.

Sport and physical activity play important roles in such debates. Not only can a look at sport used to qualify our understanding of the role of the human body in society at large, the very nature of sport – the competition between bodies – creates own debates about the autonomy of the body. Whether it is the abuse scandal around the US gymnastics team, amateurism in college sport, or medical debates about head injuries in football/soccer, all those discussions eventually deal with rights and responsibilities about athletes and their bodies.

However, we understand "body" not only as the human body. It can also be an organized group of people with common objectives, such as a sport organization. In recent years, athletes have challenged the traditional, hierarchical sport structures which led to the emergence of independent, athlete-led bodies of representation. Such disruptions over the ownership of sport and its revenues are on the agenda of sport institutions as well as academics. We are therefore honored that a group of internationally renowned scholars from Utrecht University (The Netherlands) took the initiative to organize a panel discussion and parallel sessions on control and power in sport organizations and in network of sport organizations.

Over the past months, we have moved forward with two publication projects within the Sport & Society Research Network. The Sharp Ideas in Sport series has been launched with the first two volumes: Competition, Fairness, and Equality in Sport and Society (by Verner Møller) and Athletes Pressing Charges(by myself). The series is aimed to advance existing contemporary discussions on sport and body culture through providing critical debates and challenging perspectives. The series is established with the ambition to create a hub for controversial, radical, and provocative views that challenge current insights into global sport via a concise pocketbook format.

Moreover, in the coming weeks we will launch a Sport & Society Digital Pocket Teaching Book Series with numerous books targeted at undergraduate students. The short books are intended to fill the gap between overly broad academic textbooks and content-specific academic papers, and will be linked to a digital platform on which lecturers and students can access additional learning/teaching material.

AARHUS UNIVERSITY

Finally, I would like to thank Common Ground Research Networks for their continuing support to our Sport & Society section. Under the leadership of Phillip Kalantzis-Cope and Tamsyn Gilbert, the staff members have been incredibly supportive of all our new ideas and initiatives. I am also grateful for their trust in organizing the 2022 Sport & Society Conference at Aarhus University.

I wish everyone an insightful and thought-provoking conference, including a wonderful experience in Aarhus – the home of hygge.

Yours sincerely,

Jörg Kreiger

COMMON GROUND

Dear Conference Delegates,

From wherever you've come, in which way you're participating, welcome to the **Thirteenth International Conference on Sport & Society**. I am grateful to all of you for sharing your work at this conference.

For over 30 years, Common Ground has invested in developing technologies that seek to break down barriers of access in scholarly communication. In each phase, we've built spaces to support interdisciplinary dialogue, before such approaches were in vogue; connected international voices when disciplines were too often isolated in national silos; and supported an agenda of access and equality, by offering pathways and opportunities for diverse voices. We now propose another kind of intervention -- to build a scholarly communication infrastructure for a blended future. Our blended model seeks to transcend physical boundaries by offering a space to extend in-person conference content online while ensuring online-only delegates are afforded equal participatory and experiential spaces within the platform. At the same time, the model offers participants a legacy resource to which they can return, with access to a social space where fellow participants can keep connected long after the conference ends.

But for us "blended" is more than an approach to technology. We're using this conceptual filter to consider our mission:

- Blended disciplines as an approach to interdisciplinary research practices
- Blended affinities as a way to approach a shared politics for paradigms of recognition and redistribution
- Blended voices as a way to consider where research happens in and outside of academia
- Blended ideas as the common ground for a new sense of civics

We're also committed to being industry leaders. In 2021 we became a signatory to the United Nations Sustainable Development Goals Publishers Compact. Launched in collaboration with the International Publishers Association, the compact "features 10 action points that publishers, publishing associations, and others can commit to undertaking in order to accelerate progress to achieve the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) by 2030. Signatories aspire to develop sustainable practices and act as champions of the SDGs, publishing books and journals that will help inform, develop and inspire action in that direction.

Alongside becoming a signatory to the UN Sustainability Publishers Compact. I had the honor of leading Common Ground Research Networks delegation to COP26 in Glasgow late last year. We are measuring current emissions in all aspects of what we do to identify areas where emissions can be reduced. And we're committing to long-term science-based Net-Zero targets for our operations. We'll be sharing a report of our activities and progress annually, so watch this space.

I thank our partners and colleagues who have helped organize and produce this meeting with great dedication and expertise.

Warm Regards,



Dr. Phillip Kalantzis Cope
Chief Social Scientist, Common Ground Research Networks



Sport & Society
Research Network

Founded in 2010, the **Sport & Society Research Network** is brought together around a common interest in cultural, political, and economic relationships of sport to society. We seek to build an epistemic community where we can make linkages across disciplinary, geographic, and cultural boundaries. As a Research Network, we are defined by our scope and concerns and motivated to build strategies for action framed by our shared themes and tensions. You can become a participant by submitting a presentation to our annual conference, a research article to one of our journals, or book proposal to our imprint.

Game Logic

How do we negotiate game logic?

Sport's psycho-social motivations are built around a variety of game logics. Games are spaces of recreation and leisure; they are places of not-work; they stand outside the immediately functional, productive logics of employment and citizenship. However, they also reflect and reinforce the moral meanings of broader society: the values of energetic commitment; the virtue of developing skill; the challenge of striving to achieve; the rigors of competition; the rewards afforded to effort; the ethics of formal equality of opportunity (the level playing field); the vicissitudes of chance; magnanimity in loss; and in team sports the ethics of collaboration. The virtues of the "sporting spirit" are complement aspirational values in a wide variety of practices in education, work, and civic participation.

Yet the spirit of sport sits in tension with other complex and at times contradictory forces, ostensibly less part of its "true spirit" but which nevertheless at times seem intrinsic to its gaming logic. Is sport ritualized aggression, quasi-military in its formation, and to the extent that it is, is it a catharsis or catalyst sublimating other problems? Are values of competition a necessary and proper reflection of the motivations that drive market societies, or do they represent 'survival of the fittest' logic in which a few perennially win at the expense of the many who, game logic dictates, must lose? To what extent does game logic also tempt transgression of rules, from cheating to doping? How do we negotiate racism, sexism, homophobia and denigratory nationalism in sports?

Body Logic

How do we understand the body?

Sport also rests on a range of body logics. One logic is one of health, a counterpoint to work which for the majority of modern people is largely sedentary. Sport is a necessary antidote. Another logic is that of body image, captured visually in the ideal type of the physically fit man or woman. Another logic is body-to-body contact, the strictly delimited violence of contact sports or bodily co-ordination in sports of graceful movement. Another is the subtle or not-so-subtle expression of sexuality in sport.

However, sitting in tension with these idealizations are difficulties and challenges intrinsic to the logic of the sporting body itself. How do we make sports accessible to, and inclusive of, bodies outside of the ideal body type? How do we deal with the tendency to lionize unnatural extremes in the sporting body, and the over-exercise, drugs or assistive technologies which may be used to produce extreme effects? How do we reduce violence in sport and connected with sport? How do we address the perils of the sexualization of sport? How do we negotiate polyvalent sexualities?

Aesthetic Logic

How does sport shape aesthetics?

There are multiple aesthetics to sport, too. Sporting activities are driven by stories. The game is an open-ended, participatory narrative. It is a journey in time and space–the race or the match, for instance. Sporting achievements fold into everyday life narratives. Then there is the intrinsic aesthetic of movement, of graceful or impressively forceful bodies in time and space, of being outdoors or in a specially designed indoor spaces. Sport is also driven by ritual: formalised beginnings, stages and ends for participants and the stuff of spectacle and entertainment for viewers. This is the raw material for representation in conversation, media, advertising, and the arts-through discourses, imageries, sounds, and tactile sensations. Sport's sites of representation are print, television, radio, the internet–indeed any and all media, each with its characteristic forms and all in a state today of radical transformation.

However, sitting in tension with a positive aesthetics are the often crude functionalism of sporting spaces, the rabid commercialization of popular sport, the passivity of the spectacle and limited and differential access to the media for different sports or categories of player.

Organizational Logic

How is sport organized?

Sports are forms of social organization. They depend upon, and are always supported by, institutional infrastructures and processes of management. Physical facilities are needed. Players need to learn to play. They need times and places to practice, and coaches to lead. These are the pragmatics of doing sport, and doing it well. This is the stuff of sports education, sports medicine and sports management, practiced by and for amateurs as well as professionals.
However, how does organization logic at times lead to excessive commercialism or even exploitation? When it does it become overburdened by bureaucracy? When does leisure become work in a way that perhaps defeats the purpose of sport-as-leisure?

The International Conference on Sport and Society and its companion journal, book series, and online network are places for the systematic examination a relationship in which sport oft-times enhances social life, while at other times it reflects broader social challenges as well as raising challenges unique to sport itself. These are the discussion forums of this knowledge.

Theme 1: Sporting Cultures and Identities

On sport's motivations, meanings and purposes. Includes the psychology of sport and the interplay between individual identities and access, equity, and participation in sports. Examines the social and sociological aspects of sport, the impact of cultural traditions and cultural differences on how sports are played or viewed, and the influence of sports on national, ethnic, or community identity.

- Individual identity (race, gender, ethnicity, religion, etc) and impacts on sports participation
- Group identities – community, nations, cultures
- Values- as exemplified by athletes, fans, communities
- Cultural differences or traditions
- Psychology or sociology of sport
- Historical perspectives on sport and athletes
- Sport and community building
- Nationalism and ethnic identity in sport
- Exclusionary and inclusionary practices in sport: access, equity and their social benefits
- Human rights in sport

Theme 2: Sport and Health

On the relationship of sports participation to physical, mental, or emotional health and wellbeing. Includes the study of health, nutrition, exercise science, sports medicine, and biomechanics. Examines the relationships between health/physical fitness and other aspects of life (cognitive abilities, work performance, social interactions).

- Exercise, fitness, and physical wellbeing
- Sport and recreation in psycho-social wellbeing
- Sports medicine and health sciences
- Drugs in sport
- Exercise science, sport biomechanics, functional anatomy
- Sports injury---prevention, identification, rehabilitation
- Sports nutrition and exercise metabolism
- Sports and disabilities
- Health and fitness in the workplace

Theme 3: Sports Education

On learning about and through sport. Includes physical and health education in schools and communities, teaching and coaching techniques. Examines how sports programs in schools and communities promote learning, tolerance, social cohesion, and community development.

- Physical and sports education
- Health education in schools and communities
- Community based youth sports
- Sports programs in schools, colleges, and universities
- Coaching and instructional, motivational strategies

Theme 4: Sports Management and Commercialization

On sports organizations, leadership, and management. Considers sports and sporting events as commercial activities. Explores the impact of sports and sporting events on communities, nations, international relations. Includes sports as a profession and the roles of professionals (athletes, coaches, media and marketing professionals) within it. Examines policies, rules and regulations, and laws related to governance and participation.

- Management of sports organizations and sporting events
- Marketing, branding, and building a fan base
- Communications and media coverage of sports
- Sponsorship, licensing and advertising in sport
- Commercialization, commoditization and privatization of sport
- Professionals in sport
- Sports facilities: design and management
- Adjudication, refereeing, rule making and game governance

https://sportandsociety.com/about/themes

Chair and Advisory Board

Sport & Society

Research Network Chair

Jörg Krieger

Aarhus University, Denmark



Since April 2019, **Dr. Jörg Krieger** is Associate Professor in Sport and Social Science at Aarhus University. He was formerly employed at the Institute of Sport History and Olympic Studies Centre of the German Sport University Cologne, where he completed his PhD. His main research fields are the history of doping and anti-doping, transformation processes in the International Association of Athletics Federations, the history of the Olympic Movement and the Youth Olympic Games. In 2016, Jörg published his monograph "Dope Hunters" with Common Ground. In the book, he examines the evolution of scientific knowledge within the international anti-doping community that coalesced during the second half of the twentieth century. Jörg has published in leading international journals and is a member of various international academic networks.

Advisory Board

The **Sport & Society Research Network** is grateful for the foundational contributions, ongoing support, and continued service of our Advisory Board.

- **Jean Côté**, Queen's University, Canada
- **Hjunjoo Cho**, Korean Institute of Sport Science, South Korea
- **Efthalia Chatzigianni,** University of the Peloponnese, Greece
- **Rylee A. Dionig**i, Charles Sturt University, Australia
- **Yoav Dubinsky**, University of Oregon, United States of America
- **Austin Duckworth**, Independent Scholar, United States of America
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- **Maria Pontes Ferreira,** Wayne State University, United States of America
- **April Henning,** Stirling University, United Kingdom
- **Jörg Krieger**, Aarhus University, Denmark
- **Peter Omondi-Ochieng**, University of Louisiana at Lafayette, United States of America
- **Jennifer Pharr**, University of Nevada, Las Vegas, United States of America
- **Joe Recupero,** Ryerson University, Canada
- **Ian Ritchie**, Brock University, Canada
- **Laurel Walzak,** Ryerson University, Canada

https://sportandsociety.com/about/advisory-board

Thirteenth International Conference on **Sport & Society**

For over 30 years, Common Ground has been invested in crafting forums that seek to break down barriers of access in scholarly communication. In each phase, we've built spaces for interdisciplinary dialogue, before such approaches were in vogue; connected international voices when disciplines were too often isolated in national silos; and supported an agenda of access and equality, by offering pathways and opportunities for diverse voices.

We now propose another kind of intervention -- a scholarly communication infrastructure for a blended future.

Our blended model seeks to transcend physical boundaries by offering a space to extend in-person conference content online while ensuring online-only delegates are afforded equal participatory and experiential spaces. At the same time, the model offers participants a legacy resource to which they can return, with access to a social space where fellow participants can keep connected long after the conference ends.

In this future we also commit to bilingual pathways.

We support the presentation, publication, and social networking for English and Spanish speaking delegates. In doing so we seek to offer spaces where we can "speak our language" and at the same time interact together.

And blended is more than technology.

And blended is more than an approach to technology. We're using this conceptual filter to consider some of our original mission positions: blended disciplines as an approach to interdisciplinary research practices; blended affinities as a way to approach a shared politics for recognition and redistribution; blended voices as a way to consider where research happens in outside of academia; blended ideas as the common ground for a new sense of civics.

History



Founded in 2010, the International Conference on Sport & Society is brought together around a common interest in sport's cultural, political, and economic relationships to society. We seek to build an epistemic community where we can make linkages across disciplinary, geographic, and cultural boundaries.

Past Events:

- 2010 - UBC Robeson Square, Vancouver, Canada
- 2012 - Cambridge University, Cambridge, UK
- 2013 - University Centre, Chicago, USA
- 2014 - Universidade Salgado de Oliveira, Niterói, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil
- 2015 - University of Toronto, Toronto, Canada
- 2016 - University of Hawaii at Manoa, Honolulu, USA
- 2017 - Imperial College, London, UK
- 2018 - Florida International University, Miami, USA
- 2019 - Ryerson University, Toronto, Canada
- 2020 - University of Granada, Granada, Spain (Virtual)
- 2021 - University of Granada, Granada, Spain (Virtual)

Partners

AARHUS UNIVERSITY

FIU FLORIDA INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY

Toronto Metropolitan University

UNIVERSIDAD DE GRANADA

www.sportandsociety.com/about/history



Whose Body Is It? The Problem of Autonomy in Sport

For human beings, our bodies serve as the material basis of our existence. Without our physical bodies, we would not be able to engage in social practices. And while we cannot choose our body, we can throughout our lives shape our body and attempt to make it "our own." Unfortunately, however, we are not the only ones trying to control our bodies. Politicians, businesses, social groups, and other individuals also are interested in "own" our bodies. As a result, they profoundly influence the meaning of "our" bodies via defining the limits of what, where, and how we can use them.
At this year's conference, we want to investigate how bodies are free and governed in all levels of sport, from:

- **Legal perspectives**: who owns an athlete's body? Is it a club, sponsors, or the public?
- **Organizational aspects:** do existing governing bodies of sport require reforms?
- **Medical aspects:** what is the role of medical doctors, physiotherapists, coaches in overseeing athletes' bodies?
- **Socio-cultural meanings:** are we considering dynamic changes in gender, race, and cultural definitions of bodies
- **Historical legacies:** what have been attempts by sports organizations to control elite athletes via "body rules", and what are the lessons learned?

We are both interested in work that deals with these challenges on a day-to-day level and speculative theoretical work that positions sports and society researchers at the forefront for interpreting and acting on broader social movement.

Dr. Jörg Krieger
Associate Professor, Aarhus University, Denmark

2022 Conference Chair

Jörg Krieger
Aarhus University, Denmark



Since April 2019, **Dr. Jörg Krieger** is Associate Professor in Sport and Social Science at Aarhus University. He was formerly employed at the Institute of Sport History and Olympic Studies Centre of the German Sport University Cologne, where he completed his PhD. His main research fields are the history of doping and anti-doping, transformation processes in the International Association of Athletics Federations, the history of the Olympic Movement and the Youth Olympic Games. In 2016, Jörg published his monograph "Dope Hunters" with Common Ground. In the book, he examines the evolution of scientific knowledge within the international anti-doping community that coalesced during the second half of the twentieth century. Jörg has published in leading international journals and is a member of various international academic networks.

Host Institution

AARHUS UNIVERSITY

Jules Boykoff

Professor, Politics & Government Department Chair, Pacific University, United States



Jules Boykoff writes on a range of subjects, including political activism, the Olympic Games, and climate change. He is the author of four books on the Olympics–NOlympians: Inside the Fight Against Capitalist Mega-Sports in Los Angeles, Tokyo, and Beyond (Fernwood, 2020), Power Games: A Political History of the Olympics (Verso, 2016), Activism and the Olympics: Dissent at the Games in Vancouver and London (Rutgers University Press, 2014), and Celebration Capitalism and the Olympic Games(Routledge, 2013). He also wrote two books on the suppression of political dissent–Beyond Bullets: The Suppression of Dissent in the United States (AK Press, 2007) and The Suppression of Dissent: How the State and Mass Media Squelch USAmerican Social Movements (Routledge 2006)–and co-authored with Kaia Sand Landscapes of Dissent: Guerrilla Poetry & Public Space (Palm Press, 2008).

Boykoff writes across academic disciplines, publishing peer-reviewed articles in fields such as political science, sociology, geography, environmental studies, and history.

His work has been published in journals like Social Movements Studies, PS: Political Science and Politics, Contemporary Social Science, Antipode,Human Geography, New Political Science, Capitalism Nature Socialism, Sociology of Sport Journal, International Review for the Sociology of Sport,Global Environmental Change, and Oregon Historical Quarterly.

He has written commentaries on politics for outlets such as the Guardian, the New York Times, New Left Review, The Nation, the Los Angeles Times, Dissent Magazine, Extra!, and Street Roots.

Boykoff is also a poet. He is the author of three full-lengths poetry collections–Fireworks (Tinfish Press, 2018), Hegemonic Love Potion (Factory School, 2009), and Once Upon a Neoliberal Rocket Badge (Edge Books, 2006)–as well as numerous chapbooks. He also collaborated with visual artist Jim Dine on The Slow Motion Underneath (Steidl Editions, 2008).

Boykoff holds a Ph.D. in political science from American University. He currently teaches political science at Pacific University in Oregon. He lives in Portland with his wife Kaia Sand and their daughter Jessi Wahnetah.

Rob Koehler

Director General, Global Athlete, United States



Rob Koehler is the Director General of Global Athlete. Global Athlete is a movement by athletes for athletes aiming tocollectively inspire and drive change across the world of sport. Over the past several years Rob has worked with thousands of athletes to help amplify their voice, seek justice and force change for stronger athlete rights in international sport.

Rob commenced his work in the sporting world working at a community level and quickly transitioned into a role with the Spirit of Sport Foundation in Canada by traveling across his home nation with Olympians in lead up to the 1996 Atlanta Olympic Games. During this time, he promoted athlete involvement and engagement while at the same time teaching young people about the values of sport. Rob worked with the Canadian Centre for Ethics in Sport from 1997-2000 where he oversaw major Games work including oversight of the 1999 Pan American Games anti-doping program. When the World Anti-Doping Agency (WADA) was established in 1999, Rob took on a role as Chief Executive Officer of the Drug Free Sport Consortium whose role was to help WADA implement its first out-of-competition testing program leading up to the 2000 Sydney Olympic Games. In 2002, he became a full-time employee at WADA and during his tenure held positions as a Deputy Director of Standards and Harmonization, Director of Education and Program Development and the agency's Deputy Director General. Rob resigned from WADA in August 2018. Prior to his resignation Rob was responsible for the oversight of the Russian Roadmap for Russia's return to compliance. During his time at WADA, he was a strong advocate of the athlete voice and was responsible for working with the WADA Athlete Committee.

Mads Brix Baulund

DIF Athletes Committee, Denmark



Mads is a former Paralympian and current member of the Danish Athlete Committee and Parasport Denmark Elite Sports Committee and Development Committee. He has been involved with the disability movement and advocacy for more than 15 years. Amongst other as an Executive Board member for the Disabled Peoples' Organizations Denmark as well as a being former chairman of the Danish Association of Youth with Disabilities. In 2020 he won the Danish Broadcasting Corporation's 'Role Model of the Year Award' and advocates for increased athlete involvement in decision making processes and greater athlete self-awareness.

Maarten van Bottenburg

Professor, Public Administration and Organisation Science, Utrecht University, Netherlands



Maarten van Bottenburg is professor of Public Administration and Organisation Science at Utrecht University and coordinator of Utrecht University's focus area 'Sport & Society'. In 2017 he held the Francqui Chair at the Vrije Universiteit Brussels. He was also lecturer of sport business at Fontys University of Applied Sciences (2004-2009) and research director of the W.J.H. Mulier Institute – a leading centre for research on sports in society in the Netherlands (2002-2006), of which he was also one of the founders.

As such, Van Bottenburg has been engaged in both academic research and consultancy in the field of sports for thirty years. The common thread in his work is the question of how sport is developing as a social phenomenon, which public values and public issues arise from this, and how and why the organization and management of sport have an impact on those values and issues.

Van Bottenburg published several books, articles and reports on the social meanings and public issues of sport, such as social inclusion (club life), international prestige (medal rankings), violence (extreme fighting) and cheating (doping, match-fixing).

Frank van Eekeren

Associate Professor, Sport & Society, Utrecht University School of Governance (USG), Netherlands



Frank van Eekeren is associate professor Sport & Society at the Utrecht University School of Governance (USG) and professor applied sciences 'Impact of Sport' at the Hague University of Applied Sciences. At the same time he's a board member at PSV Foundation.

He studies the value of sport in and for society with the intention to contribute to better functioning organizations and managers who in turn contribute to a vital, resilient and inclusive society. Central topics in his research are: public value creation in and through football organizations; CSR by sport organizations; societal impact of mega sport events; criminal undermining in sport; good governance and integrity in (international) sport organizations.

He considers both academic output and societal impact as his core business. Therefore, he publishes in academic journals, professional magazines, and social media. His most recent book is 'Good Governance in Sport, Critical Reflections', which he edited with Arnout Geeraert.

Each year a small number of Emerging Scholar Awards are given to outstanding early-career scholars or graduate students. Here are our 2022 Emerging Scholar Award Winners.

Zachary Consitt
York University, Canada



Tiara Cash
Simon Fraser University, Canada
Founder, Crowned Vitta LLC



Rita Pires
Aarhus University, Denmark



Lana McCarthy
Charles Sturt University, Austrailia



Tiago Fernandes Maranhão
Vanderbilt University, USA



Mauricio Hernández
University of San Buenaventura, Colombia



Each year a small number of Emerging Scholar Awards are given to outstanding early-career scholars or graduate students. Here are our 2022 Emerging Scholar Award Winners.

Natalie Dalton
University of California, USA



Constantine Psimopoulos
Harvard Medical School, USA



Wenyi Chang
National Taiwan Normal University, Taiwan



Sean Pradhan
Menlo College, USA



Rachel Roberson
University of California, USA



Eva Wolzok
National Taiwan Normal University, Taiwan



Rudy Mondragón
Visiting Assistant Professor, Pitzer College, USA & Postdoctoral Fellow, University of California, Los Angeles, USA



"Whose Sport Is It?
A Debate on Gender, Equality, and Fairness in Sport and Society"

The Sport & Society Conference is pleased to offer a Pre-Conference Panel titled "Whose Sport Is It? A Debate on Gender, Equality, and Fairness in Sport and Society"

Panelists include:

- Lindsay Parks Pieper (Lynchburg University, US)
- Jesper Andreasson (Linneaus University, Sweden)
- Ask Vest Christiansen (Aarhus University)
- Verner Møller (Aarhus University)

Date: Wednesday, June 29, 2022
Time: 17:00 (5:00 PM)
Location: Auditorium, Aarhus Institute of Advanced Studies (AIAS), Høegh-Guldbergs Gade 6B, 8000 Aarhus



Presentations
Presenters
Participants

Sport, Migration, and Social Integration: Engendering Migrant Belonging through Football

Ciaran Acton, Lecturer, Sociology, Ulster University, Antrim, United Kingdom
Teresa Willis, Lecturer, Social Policy and Criminology, The Open University, United Kingdom

Northern Ireland is a deeply divided society and historically sport has played a key role in both reflecting and reinforcing those divisions. While the nature of the relationship between sport and ethno-religious differences has received considerable academic attention, there has been relatively little research on the implications of this for the growing migrant community in Northern Ireland. Moreover, although there has been a burgeoning of international research into the use of sport as a mechanism to support the integration of migrants, this has not translated to the specific context of post-conflict societies such as Northern Ireland. This paper addresses these gaps and, drawing upon ethnographic research on a number of sport-related integration initiatives, it considers the extent to which football might help to facilitate cohesion and integration among the migrant and refugee community in Northern Ireland. In particular, it focuses on an initiative led by migrants themselves, which seeks not only to integrate migrants into wider society but also aims to encourage the development of a separate, cohesive, migrant identity within the already divided context of Northern Ireland, looking at the role sport might play in achieving this kind of integration. The study will increase our understanding of the impact of specific sport-related interventions and inform current debates concerning the complex relationship between sport, migration and social cohesion. The evidence-based data provides lessons for other societies, both within the UK and internationally, and contribute to the growing academic literature on this topic.

Perceptions of Female International Students' Lived-Experience as College Athletes

Christopher Atwater, Assistant Professor, Hospitality, Sport, and Tourism Management, Troy University, Alabama, United States
Nicole Sellars, Assistant Professor, Hospitality, Sport, and Tourism Management, Troy University, Alabama, United States
Chris Corr

While all students experience an adjustment to college (e.g., living away from family, time commitments, social opportunities, etc.), students participating in National Collegiate Athletic Association (NCAA) athletics experience additional levels of adjustment within each component of their lives. Though international athlete participation is prevalent, and increasing, little extant literature has examined the unique adjustment made by international athletes participating in NCAA Division I athletics. Furthermore, even fewer studies have examined the college adjustments made by international female athletes specifically. Female college students experience an adjustment to college that is unique from males. While financial burden and academic rigor are common adjustment stressors affecting both female and male college students, females face added social, physical, and sexual stressors. International female athletes face the combination of these adjustment components; all of which can potentially alienate them from the campus community. The present study currently being conducted aims to explore the perceptions of international female athletes at NCAA Division I member institutions. A greater understanding of the unique adjustments that international female athletes make upon enrollment, and sustained attendance, at NCAA Division I member institutions is valuable and important. Findings may serve to inform both practitioners (i.e., NCAA, Division I institutions, coaches) and academics (i.e., faculty, advisors, researchers) in assisting international female athletes as they transition and adjust to life as a college athlete in the United States.

“I Just Wish More Would Go Back to Coach”: Voices of Female Coaches in the Growing Sanctioned Sport of Girls’ High School Wrestling, and Why They Matter

Marilyn Castro, Student, Doctoral Student, University of California, Santa Barbara, California, United States
Jaquelyn Valenzuela

USA Wrestling reports that wrestling sits as the seventeenth most popular high school sport for girls, with eighteen states holding a girls’ state wrestling championship. While numerous factors may contribute to the overall experiences of female high school athletes, coaches are often cited as having extensive influence over team cultures, ultimately impacting their development; therefore, as high school girls are changing the landscape of wrestling, their female coaches are leading the way. While literature preparing coaches for an influx of female participants in the sport exists, the purpose of this study is to invoke the voices of those female coaches spearheading the way. Using an exploratory qualitative approach, five female coaches were interviewed in this study on their perspectives of the sport and its rising increase in popularity amongst girls. A semi-structured interview protocol allowed the participants to expand on areas they found critical as females navigating a male-dominated sport. An inductive data analysis approach was therefore taken to allow prominent themes to emerge. Results show that participants shared commonalities that stretched from their first experiences in wrestling, their perspectives regarding the sport’s development, lessons from the mat, and their perceived roles as females propelling the sport forward. Implications from this study further the importance of the female perspective in the male-dominated world of wrestling, particularly those of an already shrinking minority: female coaches.

A Study on International Student Athletes' Acculturation and Motivation

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Globalization has significantly altered the sporting field. It provides more resources and encourages student athletes to expand their opportunities beyond national borders. This study explores the experience of international student athletes, analyzes and reflects on the motivations, advantages, and challenges of overseas experience, and also investigate the impact of cultural differences. The in-depth interviews were conducted with three Taiwanese international student-athletes who attended the varsity at an NCAA Division I university. The research findings revealed that motivations identified by student athletes to attend a US university include experiencing a higher intensity, broadening their horizons, and learning more skills for their sports. The overseas experience is also regarded as an opportunity to develop their athletic career abroad in the future. However, being in a country with an unfamiliar culture and using a different language both bring a huge challenge for study and sports training. There are also some potential cultural differences in coaching styles, lifestyle, academic performance, and the way of communication between the US and Taiwan. To cite an instance, student athletes have to pay more attention to their studies in order to reach the grade standard for attending the competition. Even so, these high-pressure contexts help student-athletes develop higher self-discipline and mental toughness as well as improve their language proficiency. Suggestions are conducted by realizing the realities of the international student athletes experience. The knowledge revealed by this research can help better inform student athletes before making critical decisions relating to their future in both education and sport.

Protesting Is Cool, but Don't Mess With the Money: Colin Kaepernick, Racial Capitalism, and the Bounds of Black Activism

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This project utilizes the theoretical framework of racial capitalism as a theoretical foundation to analyze the coverage of former NFL quarterback Colin Kaepernick's initial decision to protest racial injustice, as well as the coverage of subsequent events such as the development of the NFL Player's Coalition. Through the use of critical discourse analysis (CDA) this paper analyzes how the media's coverage these events was shaped and influenced by the underwriting logics of racial capitalism. By deconstructing the content of mainstream newspaper coverage of Kaepernick and the subsequent focusing events related to the NFL and racial justice activism we illustrate that the true sin committed by Kaepernick was the violation of norms related to the role of Black bodies within the capitalist structure of the National Football League. Subsequently we will deconstruct the ways which the media's framing of the Player's Coalition organization, other athletes such as Malcolm Jenkins, and the NFL as an institution's broader role in society represented attempts to reestablish the boundaries around what is and is not defined as "appropriate activism". Ultimately, we argue that, despite the surface-level focus on issues such as the national anthem and respect for the military, that the greatest violation of norms committed by Colin Kaepernick through his protest was the conveyance of a message which questioned the role of the NFL and its fans in the larger capitalist systems which reproduce and replicate the widespread persecution and marginalization of people of color.

Online Workouts and Fitness Instructors' Physical Autonomy in Times of the Covid-19 Pandemic

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On March 14, 2020, Poland introduced the first lockdown of the fitness industry related to the Covid-19 pandemic. Further lockdowns were announced and lifted by the authorities several times after that, depending on the epidemiological situation. Many fitness instructors, who suddenly found themselves unable to teach their classes in fitness clubs, started to organise training sessions in an online form. The aim of this study is to explore the embodied experiences of female fitness instructors who responded to the change brought about by the Covid-19 pandemic by adopting an active coping strategy and moved their professional activity online. This paper not only touchs on how instructors continue to live out their 'instructorhood' online, but also how their engagement with digital media and technologies affects their physical autonomy and transforms their professional identity. Particular emphasis is put on the interrelations between the materiality of the human body in motion and the materiality of digital technologies. The paper is based on field work conducted in Poland (in-depth interviews with female fitness instructors, observant participation and personal experience of the researcher, as she herself has been working as a fitness instructor for years). The results of the research provide a more nuanced and complex image of the situation of fitness instructors during the Covid-19 pandemic, and of the embodied experiences of individuals facing changes related to the growing importance of digital technologies in fitness and the consequences thereof.

A Game of Offense: Understand How Media Blackballs Nonwhites in Sports

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Sports and the field of sports media are America's last remaining vestiges of a meritocracy a playing field whereby the rules are the same and apply to all equally and where individual merit and hard work is what separates the champions from the contenders. Not so. In this workshop, we will learn the six consistent image patterns that define and denigrate any non-white athlete in mainstream sports media. Further, we will deconstruct how such images are created, analyze their impact and then discuss the implications of such systematic portrayals and how they reinforce white privilege and messages of white male dominance – all in the name of "competition" and "good sport." With this dynamic at play, whereupon mostly black and brown players are generating considerable media attention and revenue particularly in the attention-dominating sports of basketball and football are critiqued and criticized by an overwhelming white male press corps, key questions evolve for examination. A key, underlying presumption within this presentation is that the assumed meritocracy of sports within mainstream media must be re-evaluated with new critical awareness insofar that members of the media and the subjects they cover are not isolated within social vacuums, but rather, are connected to larger issues of socio-economics and complex themes of political and historical natures. Hence attendees, by critically analyzing the relationship of race and sports within mainstream media, will examine and articulate the rights and responsibilities of individuals and groups in various political and social contexts. We promise to play hard.

The Unforgiven: Janet Gretzky and the Canadian Media

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Janet Jones (Gretzky) was vilified in the Canadian press for her perceived, not actual, role in the blockbuster hockey trade that involved her husband, Wayne Gretzky. Unfairly and without proof, Jones was cast as a manipulative American seductress that duped the righteous, but too trusting, Canadian hockey star into a bad decision that negatively affected his country. The media granted Jones absolution after a hasty indictment but the amnesty proved temporary. Twice more Jones found her reputation sullied by the Canadian media as it attempted to validate its initial verdict. This investigation of Canadian media illuminates important truths about its willingness to engage in gender-based chauvinism, particularly in sports sections, and the media's reluctance to move beyond those narratives even as time passed and truths were revealed. This analysis considers the reactions of local and national media and is guided by recent research into press coverage of WAGs.

Brave Blossoms, Stonehenge, and Rice Fields: Articulations of Japaneseness and Remnants of Britishness in Japanese Rugby

Christopher Hayes, Lecturer in Tourism and Events, International Business School, Teesside University, Middlesbrough, United Kingdom

2019 was a big year for rugby in Japan as it hosted the Rugby World Cup, the first Asian country to do so. Outside of Japan, the sport had hitherto been commonly associated with the nation, but domestically it enjoys great success. Through a qualitative, case study-based approach, this paper explores how the sport has developed in Japan, has been adapted to the local culture, and has challenged common notions of "Japaneseness", while at the same time recognising its British origins. Significantly, the paper shows how rugby has confronted the homogenous image of Japan, embraced multiculturalism, while also being imbued with a quality of "Japaneseness" that draws on traditional culture, spiritual belief, and community. The study has implications for the perception of the role of sport in society, not only in Japan, but across the world.

Football Practice in Brazil: Oral History and the Critical Review of the "Country of Football" (1970s-2010s)

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This paper presents the process of non-professional players and clubs claiming urban spaces for the practice of "futebol de várzea" (amateur football) in several Brazilian cities, including the state capital of Minas Gerais, Belo Horizonte. Based on this case study we aim to show new aspects of the Brazilian sports universe, orally narrated by their anonymous actors and their respective associative entities, which have less common approaches to community dimensions when compared to the international image of the "the country of football". This research uses sources and methods from Oral History, whose development in Brazil is contextualized in this paper. With the same purpose, the study presents an overview of the introduction of football studies in the country from the 1970s – when the theme was not recognized by academia – to contemporaneity, a period when research on the topic grows with significant qualitative and quantitative range.

Hitting the Barriers: Women in Formula 1 and W Series Racing

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In this paper I argue that that the major automotive racing league, Formula 1, is substandard it its efforts to be a truly unisex sport. Though women have never been officially prohibited from competing in Formula 1, there have been fewer than 10 female drivers since its inception, and in the current series there are none. This study focuses on factors preventing women drivers from securing professional driving positions in Formula 1 and from racing on equal terms with men. I argue that there are six major barriers perpetuating women's exclusion from this league: historical attitudes, current attitudes, assumed physical and mental inferiority, sexualisation, money, and representation and (in)visibility. In this cultural examination, I show that the situation for women in Formula 1 appears to be bleaker than in many other sports that are making progress in their quest for gender equality. However, it will also be suggested that, despite ethical issues, W Series - a new, women's only, single-seater car racing championship – could potentially cause positive change for women's car racing. This study employs the theories of philosopher Simone de Beauvoir on the concept of 'Otherness' (2011), and Helmut Pflugfelder's account of female embodiment in motorsport (2009). The conclusion will be that, although W Series provides a promising pathway for aspiring women drivers, more focused research and action is required around gender issues in Formula 1.

Aging and Adventure Sport: Interpreting Edgework Across the Lifespan

Moira Howes, Associate Professor, Philosophy, Trent University, Ontario, Canada

A common narrative indicates that as adventure sport and recreation participants age, they eventually focus less on bold pursuits and high performance, and more on enjoyment and the social and health benefits of their sporting activity. While this narrative reflects certain empirical generalizations about older athletes and recreationalists, I argue that it overlooks important phenomenological and philosophical dimensions of aging in adventure sport. These oversights problematically influence evaluations of boldness, vulnerability, sublime experience, and self-transcendence for older adventure sport participants. Working with concepts of relational autonomy, ontological and situational vulnerability, and impermanence, I suggest that older participants engage in "edgework" in meaningfully different ways than younger participants. Understanding these differences stands to enrich interpretations of adventure sport and its relation to character, meaning, and enjoyment across the lifespan.

Indian Premier League: Sport and the Transformation of a People's Self-conception

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The Indian Premier League, founded in 2007, is a men's professional twenty20 (t20) cricket league. Since its inception, the IPL has been the marquee t20 league in the world. Indeed, the IPL, contested during a two-month period, attracts all of best players from across the globe. This has meant that local Indian players are able to play, and compete, with the best players on the planet, facilitated by the fact that each of the 10 teams are permitted to only play a maximum of four foreign players per game, which means that a minimum of seven players must be Indian. What is more, the unrivaled player salaries offered by the IPL has meant that participation in the game has grown exponentially amongst Indian boys and young men, with a view to ultimately being drafted into the league. This has had the dramatic effect of deepening the Indian talent pool to the extent that there is unprecedentedly fierce competition for a place on the Indian national team whereby many Indian players, while often recognized as amongst the best in the world, are unable to secure a spot on the national team. Consequently, this recent generation of Indians are developing an identity and self-confidence grounded in sports and athletics, an arena that is both unprecedented and unanticipated (vs. business acumen, computer technology, Bollywood, etc.). This research examines the implications for India's place in the world as a consequence of this novel form of identity and self-confidence.

Empirical Evidence on Sports Participation and Leadership: An Analysis of Team vs. Individual Sports

Michael Insler, Associate Professor, Economics, United States Naval Academy, Maryland, United States

There is no shortage of anecdotal and testimonial "evidence" on the notion that participation in sports is a pathway to developing leadership skills and, in general, leaders. Little to no empirical evidence of such a relationship, however, exists. Arguments for such a relationship usually focus on the expectation that being on a sports team and learning how to work closely with others to achieve a shared goal develops traits that are transferable to other areas of life's endeavors. Experiencing team-building skills through sports, the argument seems to go, develops behaviors or techniques that will increase productivity in other organizations. Based on a survey that we administered to nearly 6000 graduates of the United States Naval Academy (USNA), and our ability to link the survey results to the extensive student records maintained by USNA, we empirically investigate two hypotheses: 1) Participation on intercollegiate athletic teams is statistically significantly correlated with, other observable characteristics equal, attaining a leadership position during one's active-duty Navy or Marine Corps career. 2) Participation in a "team" sport (soccer, football, basketball, baseball, etc.) is a more significant determinant, other things equal, of attaining a leadership position than participation in an "individual" sport (golf, track, wrestling, swimming, etc.) during one's active-duty Navy or Marine Corps career. We test these hypotheses using standard multivariate regression techniques. Our dataset contains a host of "leadership outcomes" beyond simply rank attained, and we also observe the scope of one's sports participation (e.g., whether and which years a varsity letter was attained).

Talent Transfer in a Danish Talent Development Context: What Characterises Talent Transfer in Denmark?

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Talent Transfer (TT) is the process that high performance athletes undergo, where they change their main sport for different reasons. The concept has never been explored in a Danish context, even though TT is happening in Denmark. The purpose of this study is to investigate what characterizes TT in Denmark, and how the Danish talent development system can develop the phenomenon to enhance the quest for international medals. Results are gathered from five individual interviews with TT-athletes and analyzed using thematic analysis. Preliminary results show that athlete rather randomly choose their sport, even though it might not fit them. Also, the period leading up to the transfer often is dominated by setbacks and dissatisfaction of different kinds. Athletes often experience rapid performance improvements in the transfer sport, which contributes to enhanced motivation and ambition level. Moreover, athletes never initiate the TT by themselves, but is encouraged to do so by others. Now the question is if we should encourage more TT in Danish talent development to prevent dropout? And is so how we can structure TT so that more athletes get the chance to fulfill their potential in another sport, that better fits their profile.

The Boateng Brothers and the Contested Nature of Germanness: Soccer and Discourses on Race, Class, and National Identity

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This paper analyzes German socio-political discourses on race, class, and national identity by studying the public perceptions of the two Afro-German soccer players Jérôme and Kevin-Prince Boateng. Jérôme and Kevin-Prince Boateng are half-brothers born to a Ghanaian father and two different German mothers. Both Boatengs are German citizens, and both played for German junior national teams – from U17 to U21. Jérôme Boateng ultimately ended up as a star player on the German senior national team, with the 2014 World Cup victory as a major career highlight. Kevin-Prince Boateng, on the other hand, was dismissed from the German U21 national team in 2009 and subsequently chose to play for Ghana's senior national team. Analyzing the public discourses on these two players illustrates the intersections of race, class, and national identity in German society. The media frequently represented the two brothers as personal opposites. Kevin-Prince Boateng grew up in a poor, working-class district of Berlin, while Jérôme Boateng spent his youth in a middle-class neighborhood of the same city. Until late into his career at Bayern Munich, public discourses constructed Jérôme Boateng as the cool and disciplined guy, the stereotypical "good" German, while Kevin-Prince Boateng was "othered" and presented as the undisciplined ghetto-kid. And while both half-brothers have the same skin color, Jérôme Boateng often performed Whiteness, while Kevin-Prince Boateng is associated with Blackness.

Football and the Problem of Cyber-Racism: Investigating Football's Response

Daniel Kilvington, Associate Professor, Cultural Studies and Humanities, Leeds Beckett University, Leeds, United Kingdom

Although English football has, to some extent, managed the problem of overt racism in and around live football matches, recent years have seen an increase of football related racist content published on social media. Kick It Out, English football's main antiracism and discrimination organisation, identified 95,000 discriminatory posts directed at EPL teams, with approximately 39,000 such posts aimed at EPL players. This paper discusses what factors have caused and encouraged the growth of racism online. For example, the nature of communication will be examined as anonymity, invisibility and feelings of privacy work to encourage online hate-speech. The paper will then consider the changes within English football fandom and quantifiably illustrate that overt forms of racism on match-days appear to be decreasing every season. That said, overt forms of racism have by no means disappeared as arguably, social media, and in particular, Twitter, has provided a new platform to spread hate. With the aid of empirical work, I will critically assesses the response of English football's institutions, organisations and clubs to the problem of racism on social media. The paper aims to highlight key research findings: there are a number of systematic failings undermining or hindering football's attempts to address this issue including poor co-ordination, a lack of clear guidelines, ad hoc educational provision, a shortage of resources, and a culture of secrecy at many clubs. The paper closes with some recommendations about how these weaknesses may start to be improved and highlights areas for further research.

Power to the People: The Politics of German Soccer Fans

Arne Koch, Associate Professor of German, Department of German and Russian, Colby College, Maine, United States

Soccer stadiums have always been political battle grounds. And as the sport permits thousands of fans to gather in essentially spaces while (social) media coverage of their activities bridges the temporal gaps between games and thereby contributes to the stabilization of fans' identity profiles, the intersection of political engagement and soccer fandom provides far-ranging insights. Select studies have already considered the juncture of group identities and political involvement for select fan groups in German soccer (Daniel & Kassimeris 2013; Totten 2014), however, this paper seeks a broader comparative approach to highlight how cultural (qua regional) differences inform political dissent and action among distinctive fan groups. By looking at the question of how fans from different regions have increasingly become focal points at the highest levels of political, media and social media debates, analysis of their positions and agendas (from widespread resistance to owner control of clubs, to involvement in players' refugee status, and from calls for exclusion of club members with particular party political affiliations, to divestment demands) will allow us to understand how German soccer fandom has evolved to serve as a principal site for articulating and contesting notions of contemporary identity beyond narrow ideas of national belonging. The understanding of how fan groups conceive of their communities as quasi-political bodies will help explain their concern with organizational constructs, norms, and borders of fan groups as well as their sense of self as public actors in discursive spaces.

Adaptive Athletics on Campus: A Case Study of the University of Arizona Model to Support Collegiate Sport

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The University of Arizona (UArizona) has a longstanding commitment to disability access, including a robust adaptive and wheelchair sports program and proud tradition of producing Paralympic athletes. The largest, most comprehensive program in the US, UArizona Adaptive Athletics recruits disabled student athletes domestically and internationally and supports nine competitive teams and an adaptive fitness center. We provide students with academic supports, like tutoring, and work to impact our campus community so that it is welcoming to disabled individuals and disability culture. Disabled students are underrepresented in American higher education at only 19%. Further, disabled people are underemployed and in 2020 the total employment rate was only 17%. At UArizona we believe sport is an inroad to higher education and can uniquely prepare students for the challenges of University and beyond, by providing a community of peers, and opportunities to hone skills like time management and communication and support the development of healthy disability identity. UArizona's Adaptive Athletics program is a unique model that benefits from the support of our local community as well as inter/national organizations that promote adaptive sport. Locally, we introduce disabled youth to sport to contribute to an educational pipeline. On an international stage, we serve as a site for mentorship and education for coaches and athletes around the world. This session will share our philosophy on adaptive athletics and practical strategies to grow opportunities for adaptive and wheelchair sports on college and university campuses.

Celebrating Together: Art and Sport at Tokyo's Olympic Agora

Kelly Salchow MacArthur, Professor of Graphic Design, Art, Art History, and Design, Michigan State University, Michigan, United States

The Olympic Foundation for Culture and Heritage established the Olympic Agora to celebrate the connections between sport and creativity. This cultural hub enabled the Olympic movement to engage with the public during the 2021 Tokyo Olympic Games through a free and accessible art and design installation. Five Olympians and one Paralympian were selected to create artworks that embodied global solidarity. This case study explores my process and resulting contributions to the initiative, as a 2-time Olympic rower, and graphic design educator and practitioner. My series of 5 Noren curtains (traditional Japanese curtains commonly hung in entryways) represents our shared experiences through sport and the Olympics. Given the period of uncertainty and challenge brought on by the pandemic, these Olympic Games were an especially poignant opportunity for the international community to celebrate optimism, hope, resilience, and determination. The Olympic Agora bridged sport and creativity, in admiration for the athletes and in reverence for global harmony, featuring art and design from diverse cultures.

The Configuration of a "Brazilian Way": Identity, Nationhood, and Sport in a Transatlantic Perspective

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This work contributes to the historiography of physical culture, race, and national identity by understanding the role of modern sports (as a branch of physical culture) in integrating societies and its impact on the debates that sought to construct a "Brazilian nation." Moreover, this study sheds some light on the web of configuration through which European and Brazilian local elites created ties and strengthened a form of control in order to 'civilize' a society with a distinct colonial background. The paper also explains the transition from the British influence to a more singular "Brazilian way" of practicing modern sports. The use of newspapers as primary source material is crucial in this essay given the habitually-overlooked relationship between the industries of modern sport and archival press. This presentation finally analyzes the reasons for the concerns with a possible "mischaracterization of the Brazilian people" and how a British sport in particular became a symbol of Brazilian national identity? This historical, intense cultural combat that took place in Brazil affected the debates on Brazilian national identity throughout the whole twentieth century, reverberating until today.

Creating a Caring and Winning Culture in the New Zealand Netball Team

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Andrew John Martin, Associate Professor, School of Sport and Exercise, Massey University, New Zealand

This paper reflects on the ways in which women leaders of the New Zealand national netball team, the Silver Ferns, have created their team culture. There is a paucity of research on leadership in high performance female sport, particularly from coaches and captains. The objective of this research is to examine aspects of culture and leadership through insights of the team leaders. These insights are developed through application of Schein's (2010) three level theoretical model of organizational culture integrating artefacts (rites & rituals, symbols and stories), values and beliefs, and core assumptions. The findings provide practical implications for coaches and managers in developing sporting cultures and team identities. Analysis of semi-structured interviews with ten former captains and coaches of the New Zealand Silver Ferns national netball team, charts the development of the evolving nature of this culture over three distinct eras of the game. This study highlights the transition of a culture from generally autocratic in the amateur period to a more empowering context in the professional era. It concludes that ultimately the culture is proving to be successful on court without sacrificing values of care and respect for all team members on and off the court. The team culture has similarities with other elite sport teams, for example focusing on winning, but perhaps a point of difference is the prominence given to a caring culture. The implications are for developing teams of women, led by women, and for women's sport culture.

Sport and Democracy: The Polemic Nature of Agonistic Social Practices

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Although consistently cited as a tenet of good governance in sport, the application of the principle democracy has been rather limited in sport. Exemplifying the relationship between democracy, sport, and philosophy by developing our understanding of the concepts polemos and agon, via conceptual analysis, can help to enhance our experience with these agonistic practices. Not all social practices are, or need to be, agonistic, but it is important to do our best to understand and take care of those essentially agonistic social practices, in order to preserve their character and enable our existence to develop in a more free and enriching way. If we are to accept that democracy and sport are inherently related, then we might consider the implications of approaching sport in a more democratic fashion. What impact could such an approach have on the sport experiences of athletes? What are the implications for governing systems? What would be the role of stakeholder education?

Women are Not Monolithic: Challenges and Barriers for Women with Physical Disabilities in Sport

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More girls and women are playing sport than ever before. If athletes participate in safe and healthy competitive environments, they can reap psychological, social, physical, and physiological benefits. Additionally, opportunities to learn and improve socially valued skills like hard work and teamwork are plentiful. Unfortunately, not all girls and women experience equitable access and participatory experiences. Ideologies associated with aspects of identity, including, but not limited to, gender, race, sexuality, ethnicity, socio-economic status, religion, and ability, challenge equitable access and experiences for girls and women in sport. Women are not monolithic. As such, different aspects of identity intersect creating unique barriers for some girls and women. Drawing from the literature, this study identifies and explores the multitude of ways ableist and gender ideologies influence the creation and support of barriers faced by female athletes with physical disabilities. Additionally, the paper explores how laws including Title IX, the Rehabilitation Act, the Individuals with Disabilities Education Act, and the Americans with Disabilities Act have contributed to improving access but have yet to meaningfully influence sport to become truly inclusive. Finally, suggestions for positive change in participation experience at the youth, interscholastic, and intercollegiate levels are suggested.

Instagram Policies and Online Abuse Towards Elite Women in Strength Sports

Catherine Phipps, Senior Lecturer, Faculty of Sport, Health, and Social Sciences, Solent University, Hampshire, United Kingdom

Social media is user-generated content which can be used by athletes as a positive platform for branding, promotion, and coverage of their sport. However, it is also a space which enables hate, abuse, public shaming, and discrimination. In this paper, gendered abuse towards elite, high-profile women in strength sports (including powerlifting, CrossFit, strongman, Olympic lifting and bodybuilding) is explored, utilising semi-structured interviews with a number of athletes. Findings demonstrate various types of gendered abuse experienced by women, from appearance-related comments and unsolicited advice to the more extreme forms of abuse a such as death threats and threats of sexual violence. Self-surveillance and silencing strategies were also critiqued by the participants. Although these findings demonstrate deep-rooted problems surrounding sexism and misogyny which go further than social media, it is also argued that platforms such as Instagram have a key responsibility in tackling these issues, and their policies currently do not do enough to prevent abuse towards women.

Challenges of Being a Young Female Thrower in Portugal: An Analysis of Gender, Sport, and Portuguese Society

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The key purpose of this study is to explore female athletes' perceptions of gender, sports, and Portuguese society. The study involves three female athletes who had long careers in Track and Field Throwing and have a middle-class background. By using unstructured interviews that lasted at least one hour and a half per athlete, different life perspectives were obtained to be analysed in the study. Categories were created to develop direct connections between the various transformations that occur during young female athletes' development. Even though athletes' stories differ from those who the male or female "judges", there is still a general sense that the athletes are suffering and being judged by patriarchal society. As a consequence, increasing research in this field is critical for the elimination of sexualization-related repercussions, such as sexual harassment and abuse in sports.

American College Football and Homophobia: An Empirical Study

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This study examines how male hegemony in team sports, such as football, promote homophobia as a form of symbolic violence and a powerful mechanism of social control. The research included the survey administration of the Attitudes Toward Gay Men (ATG) scale (Herek, 1984, 1994) to one Division I college football team on the west coast of the United States, measuring participants' relative levels of homophobia. Findings indicate that approximately two-thirds (n=65) of the members of this college football team reported a positive attitude towards homosexuality within this study, while roughly one-third of respondents had negative attitudes toward gay men. Level of religious faith, regardless of denomination, was the best predictor of participants' attitudes toward homosexuality. Finally, the paper discusses the study's limitations, directions for future research and implications to enhance a more open and inclusive climate within American college football.

Running for Kudos: Implications of Strava Use in Emerging Adult Runners

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Charlie Potts, Gustavus Adolphus College

Since its introduction in 2009, the social media fitness app Strava has recruited 50 million athletes who have uploaded 19 billion activities. Through Strava, runners can share runs and engage with other runners in both competitive and supportive ways. Despite the enormous popularity of this app, particularly among emerging adults, little is known about the implications of its use. Therefore, the purpose of this study was to explore the perceived psychosocial implications of Strava use among emerging adult runners. The central research question was: how does Strava influence perceived motivation and wellbeing in emerging adult recreational runners? To answer this question we employed a qualitative descriptive methodology by conducting semi-structured interviews, followed by thematic analysis to explore themes in the data. We recruited 15 emerging adult runners who had been using Strava for at least 6 months. Participants were asked to provide detailed responses related to the nature of their Strava use, the nature of their peer interactions, and their perception on how Strava influences their motivation for running, as well as their overall wellbeing. Better understanding the broader implications of Strava among emerging adult runners could allow professionals in sport and exercise psychology, coaching, and fitness to better utilize this tool for its motivational potential while, at the same time, assessing possible harms, such as promoting social comparison or obligatory motives for exercise.

Passion Versus Argentina: A Feminist Fan Remembers Diego Armando Maradona and Queers. His Legacy

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Fútbol (soccer) plays an essential role in times of "crisis" (political, economic, and social) within Argentina's story and remains its most organized religion. Diego Armando Maradona is their god for reasons that extend beyond the pitch. The national affinity with him provides a primer into this nation's relationship with empire (England) and subsequently reveals the queering of gender, sexuality, and race ideas. Lovers (Fans, devotees) and his haters (critics) alike recognized Maradona's untimely death in 2020 as a significant loss to Argentina's beloved sport and people. The grief and mourning that enveloped the nation brought it to its knees. For a divided Argentina and arguably to the rest of the world's most marginalized communities, Maradona serves to unite in chant and prayers against one's greatest oppressors (within and beyond) the field. I focus on three particular moments and relationships to further this conversation on Argentina and Soccer: Maradona's "hand of God" goal against England during the 1986 World Cup in Mexico, Maradona's relationship with the late trans artist Cris Miro, and lastly, I discuss Maradona's last public moments and his very "private" and preventable death. Using my anthropological and feminist fieldwork reflections and queer theory in conversation with media discourse, I argue that Maradona embodies Argentina's history, politics, and culture through his relationship with soccer. I highlight with "passion and reason" that how we remember Maradona matters to the nation, sport, and its subsequent future.

Participation of Children and Young Adults with Disabilities in Physical Activity During Leisure Time

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The aim of this review is to summarize the state of research concerning the participation from children and young adults with disabilities in physical activity during their leisure time. The project was funded by the Aktion Mensch charitable foundation. A systematic electronic review was executed using established databases and datasets, searching for studies in English and German language published from 2010 to 2020 by using relevant keywords. The studies were identified by predefined inclusion and exclusion criteria. The content relevance was evaluated in a three-step screening process. The electronic research resulted in 73350 articles, of which 48 articles where relevant for the research. These studies showed diverse factors of dependency like physical fitness, the social and familiar environment and barriers such as the availability of activity offers and the possibility of assistance. A lack of skilled trainers and unidentified inclusive activity offers were ascertained. The question and research of participation is very complex and individual. Results show that children and young people with disabilities are less involved in exercises than peers without disabilities. Action should be taken such as a barrier-free accessibility and the establishment of inclusive activity offers. This review, based on studies, where participation on physical activity was often only a sub-aspect of the scientific work. Further studies should focus on participation in physical activity using survey studies. An international comparison is needed.

Sport, Art, or Both?: Examining Conceptualizations of Dance in Ontario University Athletic Contexts

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Is dance a sport? Is dance an art? Can dance be categorized as both? The controversy surrounding dance's categorization has been an ongoing debate since the early 1970s. With no definite conclusion to this debate, dancers do not have a clear designation as either artists and/or athletes. As such, unresolved challenges remain in the perceived value and significance of dance, particularly in postsecondary contexts. The inconclusive nature of this debate has significant implications for competitive dancers in postsecondary, as their experiences as student-athletes and opportunities for participation in sport contexts are largely impacted by conceptualizations of dance by various stakeholders in university athletics. Taking this into account, this research examines perceptions surrounding dance as a sport, art, or combination of both in universities across Ontario. Competitive dancers, dance coaches, and athletic department staff in postsecondary participated in online surveys and interviews to share their individual beliefs, knowledge, and understandings about competitive dance and the ways dancers can occupy spaces as artists and athletes. Perceptions of dance from each group of key informants proved to be dependent on a range of factors within universities and across individual participants. Most participants stated they viewed dance as both an art and a sport but demonstrated tension in how dancers occupied spaces as legitimate athletes within postsecondary institutions. While participants indicated openness to the idea of dance as a sport and dancers as athletes, the ways in which this would be actually attainable at the university-level is hindered by various institutional and systemic barriers.

Sports Calendars and Competing Temporal Ideologies: The Implications of Organized Athletics in Late Colonial Kenyan Society

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My paper explores how the institutionalization of modern athletics in late colonial Kenya led to contestations over different understandings of time and productivity. Focusing primarily on archival readings from the Kenya National Archives, I show how scheduling of athletics and indeed other sporting events that accompanied institutionalization revealed competing ideals about the "proper" use of Africans' time and energy. From concerns about the athletic calendar interfering with schooling to questions about employees taking leave to participate in sporting events, the introduction of organized sports represented a clash of values. Yet these ideological clashes around sports were also compounded by weather and climatic considerations thus highlighting the central role the environment played in these discussions. These collisions of ideas among Kenyan athletes, colonial administrators, and employers help us appreciate the role of modern athletics in not only shaping late colonial society but also the influence of these administrative infrastructures on the place of women in athletics. As many African women were already excluded from these employment and educational institutions, institutionalization of sports via schools, the army and other private institutions contributed to locking out African women from the world of athletics and to their late entry into the sport. My paper considers all these different but related angles to show the implications of organized athletics in late colonial society.

Penis-washing - Tim Paine, Sexting and Saving the 'Baggy Green': The Downfall of Australian Cricket Captain over Sexting Scandal

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The Australian cricket captain is often touted as the nation's most important job, but in recent times it has been rocked by scandals. Former captain Steve Smith was axed for cheating and now his replacement Tim Paine has resigned for sexting. Paine was appointed to resurrect respect in the national team and Cricket Australia's (CA) brand after Smith's sacking and was regarded as a success. The sexting happened while Paine was employed at Cricket Tasmania (CT). Because it was considered consensual, Paine was cleared of misconduct by CT and CA in private hearings. When the matter was exposed publicly Paine resigned from the captaincy. Details emerged that he had sent a photo of his penis to the woman who then complained to CT. The scandal generated much media debate and highlighted sport scandals' importance as major selling vehicles for media organizations. Ostensibly, the media's role seemed contrary to CA's which has covered-up past player indiscretions to protect its brand. While Paine was treated sympathetically in the media, the woman's name was revealed, and details of pending criminal charges brought against her by CT. The leaking of this information raises questions about the media's relationship with CA. This paper analyses the media's manipulation of the story. It contends that once the story broke, cricket administrators and media aligned to 'wash' the player's image and protect the position of the Australian cricket captain and CA's family-oriented brand.

Contributions of Outness to Sexual Minorities' Participation in Sports: An Elaboration on Self-determination Theory

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Motivation may be an important driver of participation in sports, but traditional theories of motivation often fall short in explaining disparities for certain populations facing relative exclusion. Sexual minorities (SM), a group less likely to participate in many sports than the general population, report interest in engaging in athletic activities, but face unique barriers to doing so in a way that openly integrates their SM identity. Based on qualitative interviews with 24 sexual minority (SM) current and former athletes, I elaborate upon Self-Determination Theory (SDT) to put forward a framework of how "outness" relates to sports participation among SM. I posit that social contexts within various levels of competition affect disclosure and concealment of SM identity to others within the sports realm (i.e., teammates, coaches, athletic staff), which in turn affects queer visibility and possibilities for belonging. While participants at all levels of competition emphasized how SM identity "shouldn't matter" in sports, varying opportunities for sociality between intramurals, club, and varsity sports contexts necessitate different identity management considerations. For SM athletes, SDT's basic psychological needs of autonomy, competence, and relatedness each intersect with outness and contribute to sport persistence for this group. These results inform inclusive sporting practices for those with hidden, stigmatized identities and ensure that individuals and teams can play at their best.

Virility on Wheels: Bicycles, Gender, and Memory in French Heritage

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As France evolved from being primarily a rural to an industrial nation, the bicycle served as a marker for modernization and a mechanism for social development. My essay discusses the conditions and contradiction under which men and women participated in this national sport and pastime. I examine the symbolic centrality and social importance of the bicycle in early twentieth-century France ranging from early discussions of the appropriateness of women riding bicycles and the origins of the all-male Tour de France, to the hey-day of tandem bicycles during the Popular Front and the emergence of all-women's races. Recurring images of organized races - both amateur and professional - initially produced exhilarating and powerful images of men competing for their nation. While women took longer to participate in such competitions, they were just as quick to appreciate the opportunities for transport, independence and leisure that cycling provided. Women's columns in cycling magazines reveal their interests in touring, vacationing, and sportive attire. Indeed, some of the most virile representations of French identity from the 1930s depict working-class couples energetically enjoying their first paid vacations astride tandem bicycles. Exploiting three remarkable first-person cycling accounts taken from regional cycling magazines, I discuss how men and women took advantage of new tourism opportunities on bicyclers to visit provincial France and emerge transformed by surprisingly divergent experiences while riding side by side.
Sporting Cultures and Identities

Racism and Culture: A Case Study of Barriers Faced by Local Black Asian and Minority Ethnic Female Grassroots Soccer Players

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This study focuses on barriers to the participation of Black Asian and Minority Ethnic (BAME) females in soccer in an area in the north of England. Interviews with women demonstrate how participants had to contend not only with racism from external sources but also pressure to conform to cultural norms held by themselves, their families, and communities. Critical Race Theory (CRT) and habitus were used to explore how playing soccer challenged the cultural, social, and religious identity of participants, as well as confronting male power and practices within the game. The sport expects BAME female players to subsume their cultural identity in order to play, therefore participants called for recognition of the need to support aspects of cultural identity, such as femininity and modesty. Linked to this, they recommended greater and earlier education around BAME issues for those involved in the game, including within schools, and also more use of social media to educate a wider audience. FA campaigns targeting families, people by age range and religious groups were also suggested. To reduce drop-out rates of those who do take up the sport, the provision of a supportive social environment to boost feelings of inclusivity was reported as important.

Mentally Healthy Elite Sports Environments: Balancing Risk and Reward

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Elite sport is demanding. In order to be able to compete at the highest international level, athletes must push themselves physically and psychologically. Fluctuations in athletes' mental health are to be expected, as athletes are faced with a complex set of sports internal and external challenges (e.g., high training loads, personal identity struggles, numerous transitional events, injury or de-selection from an Olympic/Paralympic cycle). In recent years a number of successful athletes have shifted the narrative about being an elite athlete, and have publicly shared their mental health issues (e.g., Naomi Osaka, Simone Biles and Michael Phelps). We have also been witnessed to sport organisations that publicly acknowledged their responsibility in allowing cultures to arise that have compromised athletes' mental health (e.g., Danish swimming and British cycling). These examples bear witness to the fact that the uncompromising elite sport culture that emphasize winning "medals at all cost" involves a potential threat to the athletes' mental health. The research area within mental health is still relatively young compared to other areas within the field of elite sport. Definitions and terms on mental health, selfcare, athlete welfare, well-being and thriving are turning up in the literature. The first part of my PhD study will uncover and clarify the understandings we already possess – trying to really understand how can talk about mental health in a result orientated context. In this study I share some of these immediate thoughts.

Athletic Transitions: Does Prosociality Support Student-Athlete Wellbeing during Transition to Retirement?

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Collegiate athlete retirement is a major life transition that involves changes in identity, routine, and social support. Approximately 99% of the nearly half a million current NCAA athletes will retire after their collegiate career and many of these athletes struggle with feelings of loss, sadness, and anxiety during their transition to retirement. Given this, what can universities, athletic departments, and sport educators do to support the wellbeing of these athletes throughout this transition? One overlooked strategy that shows promise is prosociality, defined as kind or generous behavior (Jensen, 2016). Through a multi-method approach - obtaining converging evidence from recall surveys, weekly diaries, and experimental design - we conduct two studies to answer three research questions: RQ1: To what extent do retiring collegiate athletes engage in prosocial behavior during the time of their transition out of sport (i.e. the first year of retirement)?; RQ2: Do retired athletes who engage in more prosocial behavior during this transition cope better and experience greater psychological well-being?; RQ3: If prosociality does indeed support well-being during this transition, do social connection and/or sense of meaning provide potential mechanistic pathways? Results from these studies are presented. This research has the potential to assist the lives of many collegiate athletes who transition to retirement and inform institutional programming while supporting those communities through prosocial behaviors.

Reaching Out Through ParticipACTION: Canadian Federal Support of the Fitness Promotion Organization, 1971-2000

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Between 1971 and 2000, the Government of Canada invested in the national fitness promotion organization, ParticipACTION. Its mandate was to advertise the benefits of healthy and active lifestyles for Canadians, young and old. ParticipACTION developed creative public service announcements and community events to get Canadians moving in simple ways such as walking, running, swimming, or biking in the workplace, school, home, or park. Canadians were encouraged to reach the standard set by Scandinavian countries through the popular advertisement comparing a thirty-year-old Canadian to a sixty-year-old Swede plus fitness competitions between Saskatoon, Canada, and Umeå, Sweden. The federal government invested in ParticipACTION to reduce healthcare costs caused by a sedentary lifestyle and increase Canadians' workplace productivity by encouraging the public to participate in fitness activities. Fitness governance fell within provincial authority in Canada, but the federal government found a way around jurisdictional boundaries using ParticipACTION. By financing their operating budget, the federal government maintained an arm's length relationship with ParticipACTION to promote their message of a healthy active lifestyle without interfering in provincial rights. For nearly thirty years, ParticipACTION's logo and message became widely recognizable across Canada and motivated millions to leave their homes to get active together. By the end of the century, ParticipACTION was forced to close after the federal government severely reduced its funding in favour of high-performance sport. This paper analyzes the federal objectives to invest in ParticipACTION, the organization's creative marketing strategy, and the influence of the organization on a generation of Canadians.

The Invisible Injury: Mental Health In Sports

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Student-athletes have a greater risk of mental health problems than their non-athlete counterparts yet are less likely to take advantage of mental health services (Gulliver, Griffiths, & Christenses, 2012). This discussion will highlight mental health risk that athletes may experience and how society views high profile athletes with mental illness. Case studies of elite athletes will be presented; then there will be an active exploration of how pressure, social media, sex, and race are contributing factors.

Fit for Politics?: How Life Time Fitness Found Politics and Framed the Pandemic

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The onset of the coronavirus pandemic in 2020 left health clubs shuttered for months and subject to significant restrictions for much of the year, pushing many fitness companies into politics. This study identifies the issue framing strategies used by Minnesota-based health club chain Life Time, Inc. in communications to members and the general public as they became increasingly involved in politics. Unlike many groups previously studied in the context of political science and framing theory, fitness companies are not widely known as established political players. Accordingly, this research offers insight into the emergent role of gyms in policy, disease prevention and public health, and its implications for interest group and sport studies. The data for analysis comes from official communications, press releases, videos, emails, blog posts and press coverage of Life Time, Inc between the dates of March 1, 2020 and January 31, 2021. Using content analysis, descriptive statistics and Pearson correlation analysis, I delineate and interpret the relationships between problem identification and other issue framing strategies. The results model the creation and evolution of distinct issue frames as Life Time entered the political arena. When Life Time identified the virus as an issue, they were more likely to choose apolitical, information-based issue frames, in keeping with their established role as a fitness company. The problematization of policy brought forth economic, political, epidemiological and moral issue frames. These conclusions demonstrate that newly political interest groups must create, then adapt issue frames to suit their evolving agenda.

Mental Health Impacts of Transgender Sports Ban in the United States

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Transgender and gender nonbinary (TGNB) persons have gender identities, expressions, and/or behaviors not traditionally associated with the sex they were assigned at birth. In the U.S., evidence continues to show wide disparities in the social determinants of health and emotional health outcomes compared with cisgender (non-transgender) populations. Studies have found a higher prevalence of emotional health issues such as anxiety, depression, suicidality, and substance use among TGNB persons compared to their cisgender counterparts. These disparities are thought to be due to, at least in part, structural stigma in the form of discriminatory laws and policies. In 2021, 31 states in the U.S. proposed laws to ban transgender athletes from participating in sports. The purpose of this study is to examine the emotional health impacts of these laws as well as explore the multiple pathways through which these proposed sports bans influence health. This will be a cross-sectional survey of transgender people from across the U.S. Data will be analyzed using a moderated mediation analysis. This research is necessary to understand more deeply the pathways through which structural stigma impacts the emotional health and well-being of TGNB people and to educate stakeholders, policymakers, and communities about the impact of structural stigma created through law and policy on the health of TGNB people.

Sports Injuries, Concussions and Surgeries Should be Viewed as Trauma and Treated with Trauma Reprocessing Psychotherapy: Shifting the Injury Recovery Paradigm with Brainspotting to Regain Peak Performance

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When an athlete experiences an injury, concussion or surgery the expectation is they must "shake it off", "pretend" it didn't occur and return to play despite their feelings associated with the fear of reinjury. Typically after an athlete's physical injury symptoms are no longer present they are expected to immediately regain their previously achieved level of sports performance. This philosophy is contradictory to human psychophysiology. When we endure an injury, concussion or have surgery it is traumatic to our nervous system causing us to reset our homeostasis to a more hypervigilant reactive sympathetic state. This shows up psychologically in athletes as performance anxiety, anxiety, insomnia, decreased focus and depression. This shows up physiologically in athletes as hesitancy to compete, uncontrolled movements and muscle guarding, yips, block, balking, plateaus and a decrease in reaction times. Therefore, it is pertinent sports injuries, concussions and surgeries be treated with a trauma reprocessing therapy like Brainspotting. Brainspotting assists athletes in resetting their homeostasis to a calmer and more focused peak performance parasympathetic nervous system state. Various National and Olympian athlete case studies will be presented to display how the endured sports injuries, concussions and surgeries resulted in a sports performance decline and how through Brainspotting the athletes regained and expanded on their sports performance capacity. In closing participants will have the opportunity to participate in a group Brainspotting experiential.

The Role of Integrity in Addressing Abuse in Sport

Katherine Starr, CEO, Team Athlete Integrity, Ltd, United Kingdom

I started Safe4Athletes over 10 years ago and have since built a reputation as an expert on sexual abuse in sport and more precisely coach-athlete dynamics. After tirelessly addressing the issue while working with athletes and teams over the years, patterns started to appear that were common to every athlete, coach or parent that came to me for help. The issue almost inevitably boiled down to "integrity." What do I mean by that, if an athlete isn't speaking up, isn't that in itself is being out of integrity? If a coach is driven based on accomplishment at the cost of overlooking the athlete, is that not being out of integrity? If a parent is driven to make sure their kid gets a scholarship or equivalent while overlooking the child's well-being, is that not being out of integrity? Those are just a few examples where a stakeholder in that scenario is out of integrity. When one part of the system is out of integrity then the whole system breaks down. A broken system is vulnerable to abuse. After seeing these patterns consistently in sport, I felt it was prudent to the address the issue where the issue ultimately resides with the a stakeholder whom is out of integrity. With that in mind a formula started to develop, to move integrity through the system. The important part is the structure as to how integrity is found and maintained creates an equitable environment for all stakeholders.

The Participation ARC: Using Self-determination Theory to Optimize Training Experiences of Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu Practitioners

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Brazilian Jiu-Jitsu (BJJ) is a grappling martial art akin to wrestling. BJJ has a relatively short history in the United States, arriving in 1993 via the Ultimate Fighting Championship (UFC), a sports promotion that has ascended in popularity and cultural influence–bringing this once fringe activity more mainstream. Research shows participation in BJJ positively affects practitioners' optimism and life satisfaction (Wojdat, et al., 2017), spiritual awareness (Pope, 2019), and well-being outside of BJJ (Chinkov, 2014). As the popularity of BJJ increases, how participants can safeguard against potential pitfalls of participation such as overtraining or neglecting other life priorities is less understood. Self-determination theory (SDT; Deci & Ryan, 1985) provides a framework for exploring how an understanding of participants' motivations for engaging in BJJ can help them reap the benefits of participation while mitigating the risks. This mixed method study explored BJJ practitioners' motivations for participating in BJJ in the context of SDT–fulfilling psychological needs for autonomy, relatedness, and competence (Deci & Ryan, 1995). We asked the question: How can an understanding of the motivations of BJJ practitioners using the lens of SDT inform healthy participation patterns? Data collection included responses by100 BJJ practitioners to a Likert-scale and short answer survey. Preliminary results suggest (a) BJJ satisfies three dimensions of SDT and positively affects mental, physical, and emotional health; and (b) barriers to healthy participation align with the theme of overreliance on BJJ for a sense of well-being.

The Relationship between Allocated Funds and College Student Return on Investment at Public NCAA Division I Institutions

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American colleges are spending more money to provide competitive athletic programs (Huml et al., 2019). The vast majority of collegiate athletic departments operate at a deficit and thus rely heavily on institutional support. (Lipford & Slice, 2018; Osborne et al., 2020). This institutional support is commonly referred to as allocated funds (NCAA, 2020). One example of these allocated funds are student fees, which are becoming a progressively larger component of athletic department funding. The typical American college student graduates with tens-of-thousands of dollars in student loan debt (Payscale, 2019). College Return on Investment (ROI) rankings should be considered while making decisions regarding college enrollment (Payscale, 2019). The purpose of this study is to examine the relationship between allocated funds and college ROI. The researcher utilized data provided to the public via USA Today's 2018 NCAA Athletic Department Revenue Database and college ROI data (Payscale, 2019). Pearson's Correlation was utilized to measure the relationship between percentage allocated and college ROI. The researcher identified a significant relationship between allocated funds and college ROI; $r\ (228) = -.29$, $p < .01$. There was a negative, inverse relationship. This offers great insight for prospective college students, their families, as well as administrators at public NCAA Division I institutions. Results revealed that colleges relying more heavily on students to subsidize athletic programs are often providing those students with weak ROI. The researcher recommends that colleges offering weak ROI spend less money on their athletic endeavors in order to avoid exploiting their students.

Implications of Collegiate Athletic Donors' Attitudes Toward National Anthem and COVID-19 Protocols

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Two major societal athletics issues in the US are national anthem actions by collegiate athletes and COVID-19 protocols implemented for collegiate athletic events. Athletic donors are a major source of revenue for US colleges/universities and the above topics have proven to be divisive societal issues. This research contributes to the knowledge on collegiate athletic donor behavior by examining the impact of national anthem protocols and COVID-19 attendance limitations. Over 100 collegiate athletic donors were surveyed about their attitudes and behaviors regarding these topics. Given the increasing concern for social justice, the national anthem protocol issue has been magnified as student athletes from numerous schools engaged in acts of demonstration during the anthem, typically kneeling. In addition, athletic departments' funding has been challenged by revenue shortfalls due to COVID-19 cancellations and limited event attendance. Thus, donor contributions have never been more important to institutions. When allowing national anthem demonstrations and limiting spectators due to COVID-19, it is imperative to understand athletic donors' views. However, little is known regarding their impact on collegiate athletic donor attitudes and donation behaviors. Results show that donors were split on student athletes' right to kneel during the anthem and who should make that decision. Further, donors reported that having student athletes kneeling during the national anthem at institutions they donate to would effect their donation behaviors. Regarding COVID-19, donors generally were not in favor of canceling events even when considering student athletes' health. However, prohibition of collegiate sporting attendance typically will not effect future donation behaviors.

The Inequality of NCAA College Football: Quantifying the Chasm in Football Economics

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The focus of this study is to examine the dispersion of football-generated revenue and athlete talent amongst Football Bowl Subdivision (FBS) teams in the modern College Football Playoff (CFP) era. This research is a follow up to Caro and Benton's examination of the "Great Divide" in 2012. The aim is to determine if the last decade has closed the parity gap between Group of Five and Power Five classified conferences and determine the impact of classification status on revenue and recruiting. The results of this study indicate that the conference stratification that existed through the BCS era has intensified over the last decade. This study quantifies the inequality in college football and recommends means to correct or control this disparity. While "nobody is broke", college football may be past the point where parity in recruiting and revenue can be achieved. The implications and realities of this outcome are considered here.

The Commercialised Professional Darts Corporation Darts Arena as a Live Event Space : The Site of the Televised Sports Spectacle

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Since the late 2000s, the Professional Darts Corporation (PDC) have created a circuit of live darts events in a variety of venues across the globe which has developed into a hugely popular multi-million pound television spectacle. The fans are one of the central focuses of the live events, with a variety of media outlets regularly showcasing commercialised, performative fandom. Although the popularity of the live PDC darts events has been highlighted in news media and by the likes of Chaplin (2009) and Davis (2018; 2020) in academia, the actual sites of live PDC darts events have not been explored. Via qualitative research, using a number of ethnographic methods when attending live PDC darts events across three seasons. This presentation analyses the intricacies of the physical PDC darts arena as an event space, explaining the structure of the PDC darts arena and how these venues allow fans to create the revered atmospheres across sites in different continents. Explaining the structure and nuances of the PDC darts arena, compared to purpose-built sports stadia, helps to ascertain why the PDC, as a governing body, rely on the performances of the fans to create an atmosphere to continually develop their product.

When Politics Trumped Sports: West Germany and the Boycott of the 1980 Summer Olympics in Moscow

Victoria Harms, DAAD Visiting Assistant Professor, History, Johns Hopkins University, Maryland, United States

In May 1980, the West Germany parliament voted to join the US-led boycott of the XXII Summer Olympiad in Moscow. Although functionaries and athletes, among them the gold medalist fencer Thomas Bach, vehemently protested the politicization of sports, the financially dependent NOC had no other option but to adopted the political decision and West Germany abstained from participation. Nevertheless, two weeks before the opening ceremony, while athletes stayed home, West German Chancellor Helmut Schmidt, an advocate of the 1979 NATO dual track decision, travelled to Moscow to sign major new trade agreements with the Soviet Union. The case demonstrates how at a time of heightened Cold War tensions, political necessities and economic interests easily stripped athletes and sports of their autonomy. This paper analyzes this seeming contradiction in West Germany policies towards the Soviet Union in 1980 and highlights the close, special relationship between Bonn and Moscow. Based on research in newspapers and archives (Foreign Office, Willy Weyer Archive, NOC and West Germany's Sports Federation) and an interview with former NOC and IOC member, the late Walther Tröger, this paper demonstrates how the submission of sports in 1980 convinced West German functionaries – alongside the IOC – to make the Olympics independent from supposed political necessities and the swings in attitudes by way of commercialization and sponsorship soon opening the door for corruption and nepotism.

The Super Bowl Pregame Show - a Celebration of Synergy: The Spectacle within the Spectacle

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Few spectacles can match the Super Bowl in terms of sheer excess. This is an event that embodies American values and consumerism. However, a critical examination of the pregame show on American television networks reveals a subtle but noticeable shift in focus in recent years. Certain elements have long been staples of the pregame show. There are segments devoted to American troops serving abroad, stories that celebrate unlikely heroes overcoming long odds, and the occasional glimpse into the lives of the very wealthy. With the Super Bowl pregame show now a four-hour extravaganza, the host networks are taking full advantage of the huge audiences for a wide variety of promotional opportunities. Exploiting synergies is not a new phenomenon, but instead of using part of the advertising inventory, these promotions now form part of the actual content of the pregame show. Recent examples of this include NBC's NASCAR announcers interviewing one of the network's Olympic announcers in an attempt to promote both properties during the Super Bowl LII pregame show. Andres Cantor, a well known soccer announcer for Telemundo even made an appearance to promote the network's coverage of the upcoming World Cup. Telemundo is owned by NBC's parent company, Comcast. When CBS aired the Super Bowl, they carried segments involving the game announcers and the cast of Magnum PI enjoying a snack from sponsor Pizza Hut. Synergies on the pregame show are an excellent way to identify how the Super Bowl continually reinvents itself through new methods of spectacularization.

Over the Rainbow: Investigating College Football Visiting Team Performance in the Hawaiian-Aleutian Time Zone

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Gregory Costedoat, San Jose State University

The University of Hawaii is the only school in the NCAA's Division I Football Bowl Subdivision (FBS) that is located in the Hawaii-Aleutian Time Zone, which is 3 hours behind the Pacific Standard Time (PST) Zone during Daylight Time and 2 hours behind during Standard Time. Based on previous research examining the effects of westward travel on team performance, this time difference has the potential to have an adverse impact on visiting teams that are scheduled to play in Hawaii. Specifically, visiting teams playing a night game in Hawaii may partially succumb to feelings of sleep pressure and/or the misalignment of their circadian rhythm. These disruptions have been found to increase errors, reduce the ability to maintain attention, and impair decision making in various contexts beyond sports (e.g., medicine, aviation, construction). Given this unique situation, our study examines how visiting teams are impacted by playing games in the Hawaii-Aleutian Time Zone. The current study utilizes performance data for visiting teams following the University of Hawaii's move to the Mountain West Conference from the period of 2012 to 2019. Data from the 2020 and 2021 seasons will be excluded due to the impact of the COVID-19 pandemic. We predict that visiting teams playing night games in the Hawaii-Aleutian Time Zone show performance reductions as it relates to points scored, points allowed, and actual game outcomes.

The Value of a Division I Football Player: Is the Student-Athlete Scholarship Fair Value or Athletic Participation at the Highest Level?

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The Football Bowl Subdivision (FBS) is the top level of college football in the United States. The National Collegiate Athletic Association (NCAA), the 10 FBS Conferences, and the approximately 130 colleges and universities who host FBS football programs receive billions of dollars annually from broadcasting rights fees, ticketing and gate, merchandising and branding, sponsorships, and other revenue generators from the hundreds of regular season and FBS bowl games played on various college campuses throughout the fall and early winter months. There are over 15,000 young men who play FBS football. Of these 15,000 young men, approximately 11,440 receive a student-athlete scholarship to play for their respective college or university, with the typical student-athlete receiving, on average, a scholarship valued at approximately $36,000.00. Since the NCAA, the Conferences, and its member institutions derive billions of dollars annually from the game of football, are the approximately 15,000 young men who play and receive no financial benefit, and the 11,440 young men who receive FBS football scholarships receiving a fair value for their skills to participate at the highest level of college sports? If not, what would be a fair value for the student-athlete? This study explores and attempts to answer these questions.

Sport Organizations' Diminished Autonomy through External Pressures

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Politically based manipulation of sport organizations takes place in several forms. Individuals, special interest groups, corporations, and governments effectively apply pressure, with the support of social and traditional media, to force policy change within sport organizations. Reactions to external pressures leading to diminished organizational autonomy is evident in professional USA sports including the NFL, NBA, MLB, NHL and college sport's preeminent governing body, the NCAA and its member universities. Leagues have embraced questionable political messages designed to offend and alienate large segments of the target audience (Malanga, 2020). Leagues have also acquiesced to government-based political positions, so long as there is a financial return (Bremmer, 2019). Sport franchises too have lost autonomy in the interest of bowing to powerful companies' political persuasions (Associated Press, 2020; Diamond & Radnofsky, 2021). The short and long-term effects of external pressures, reinforcing a shift of sport organization self-control to external bodies is deserving of moral analysis including long-term effects on sport and society.

I'm Sorry for Letting You Down: A Study into the Accounts Provided to the Media by Professional Athletes Following a Violation

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This study explores the image repair strategies employed by professional athletes after they had been accused of committing some sort of violation. As public figures, professional athletes are under constant scrutiny by both the media and the public. While many athletes are able to use this visibility to increase their financial standing and personal influence, as their public profile grows, so too does the risk of serious damage and loss should that profile become compromised. The need to mitigate this potential damage through image repair and restoration strategies makes this group of individuals ripe for exploration. To better understand the uses, patterns, and trends employed in the image repair strategies of professional athletes, a content analysis of the statements provided to the media over a one-year period by male athletes in three professional U.S. sports leagues was conducted. The purpose of this analysis to determine the impact that the variables of account type, violation type, account source, and sports league had on the image repair strategies employed by these athletes. The results of this study found that there was no significant association between the type of account provided and the type of violation committed or the league that the athlete plays in. It was, however, found that a significant association exists between the type of violation committed and who provided the account, as well as the type of account provided, and the source providing the account.

Sports Education

Robin's Story - from Dropping Out of School to a Career in Tennis

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This illustrative case study is a story of 66-year-old Robin from a small hockey town and their tennis coaching experience. The study focuses on understanding a person's participation in the coaching practice and the sports industry. Multiple sources of information including personal interviews, observations, students' and co-workers' perspectives offer a comprehensive picture of Robin's changing involvement with the sport over time. The story suggests evolving views on interests, constraints, difficult situations, and advocating for others. Robin's story reveals a journey through various stages of involvement such as starting, continuing, quitting, and returning to the profession. It also highlights the importance of flexibility and adaptation of numerous roles, from coach, director, marketer to manager.

Efficacy of Bicycling Education: An International Comparison

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This research creates an economic efficacy model of bicycling education through comparative analysis. Specifically, bicycling education and encouragement programs by the American League of Bicyclists and other American bicycling promoters are studied and categorized. These are compared to the education and encouragement programs of internationally known bicycling promoters and local governments in the Netherlands and Canada, including for young children in schools. The different organizations/programs have varying methodologies, data collection and perceived outcomes. These are compared through both qualitative and quantitative measurements, including econometric analysis. In the end, efficacy results are produced to judge whether specific objectives have been achieved through a particular bicycling education program and whether its success or failure arises from implementation processes or through a larger cultural lens (of where it's instituted). This can focus discussion for promoting different models of bicycling education as different constituencies will favor various costs and outcomes. There is much already published of the cost and benefits of bicycling, but this research adds a more focused analysis on the use/cost of bicycle education programs and what they accomplish for individuals and societies.

Coaching Confidence, Competence, and Connection: Examining the Effectiveness of a Feminist Framed Transformational Leadership Development Program for Female Coaches in University/College Athletics

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Gender inequity in coaching continues to be an issue in collegiate sport in Canada - only 26% of female teams and only 3% of male teams have female head coaches. Two identified issues young female coaches face in pursuit of head coaching roles include a male dominant sport culture and lack of leadership development to effectively lead in sport. This research study examines the effectiveness of a feminist framed transformational leadership development program integrated into the Canadian Collegiate Athletic Association (CCAA) Female Apprentice Coach Program (FACP), a program established in 2004 to provide opportunities and mentorship for newly graduated female student-athletes to coach in the CCAA. Mixed method surveys and a thematic analysis of transcribed interviews and facilitator observation notes found the added leadership program increased Female Apprentice Coach (FAC) perceived confidence and competence to lead in a collegiate environment while also increasing FAC, mentor coach and athletic director understanding of feminist barriers and issues for women in coaching and sport. In addition, the program provided further supports for FACs at each of the four ecological realms (individual, interpersonal, organizational and sociocultural) within the ecological model of barriers and supports for women in coaching. The research provides increased understanding and best practices for how to further maximize the impact of mentorship programs for female coaches.

Gender and 'Sport for Development and Peace' during the COVID-19 Pandemic: A Qualitative Analysis of Activities in Zimbabwe

Chiaki Okada, Associate Professor, Graduate School of Human Sciences, Osaka University, Osaka, Japan

Sport for Development and Peace (SDP) is to use sport as a tool to overcome social issues related to poverty, health, education, peace building and such. Although the expected roles of sport are various in SDP activities, more rigorous and pragmatic verification will be required to represent the inherent significances of sport under the post-COVID-19 society. A Zimbabwean NGO "Young Achievements Sport for Development (YASD)" has launched a new program named "GOAL", which is an international program to focus on the vulnerable women who have been impacted by the pandemic, and tries to distribute some social knowledge about "health" "money saving" "empowerment" and "self-esteem" through sports and physical exercise. This study investigates the effect of GOAL with survey of 25 respondents, between August 21 and 31, 2021. The findings suggest the need to use sport to address social concerns and emphasize its role in empowering women and developing their life skills. The results further reveal that SDP activities can pave the way for a more balanced outlook and sustainable future for the community, given the increasing financial responsibilities and social isolation experienced by women worldwide.

Internship at All Cost?: Potentials and Pitfalls in Employability-based Course Programs in Sport Science Education

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Simon Lonbro, Aarhus University

In this case study we aim to highlight the potentials and pitfalls in the content and construct of curriculum-based internship programs of higher education in Sport Science at a Danish University. Firstly, we analyzed one hundred student assignments concerning student reflections on relevant work tasks, perceived barriers, possibilities, and learning outcomes in their eight- week internships. Secondly, in a following focus group interview, the student statements were compared with the perspectives from five labor market representatives from (1) sport organizations, (2) sport clubs, (3) schools, (4) private companies, and (5) municipalities and regions. We found a robust association between applied knowledge, skills and competencies reported by students and the focus group attendants. However, we highlight the importance of distinguishing between generic and education-specific knowledge, skills and competencies. In addition, we emphasize the prominence of a transparent course program in order to explicit the actual and intended interplay between on and off campus activity, as well as coordination, early dialogue and collaborative engagement between placement supervisors, students and educational institution supervisors. Employability, student autonomy and the acquisition of research-based knowledge are essential aspects of academic education and university policy. However, if they are not well balanced, there is a risk that one aspect will disavow the other. Specifically, when research-based, theoretical teaching on campus is converted into carefully structured placement activities in practice, student incapacitation and an inappropriate narrowing of academia might occur. This must be considered in the development and settlement of employability-based course activities at the universities.

Gender and Racial Disparities in Pennsylvania High School Sport Participation: Why Sport Participation Rates are Not Equal

Liz Wang, Professor, Marketing Department, West Chester University, Pennsylvania, United States
Claire Boczkowski, Student, High School, Bayard Rustin High School, Pennsylvania, United States

This study focuses on high school sport participation based on gender and race. There has been an increase in enrollment of minority students in high school and an increase in female participation in sports in the US. Our objective is to investigate whether these changes affected gender and racial gaps in high school sport participation. We analyzed data from the Pennsylvania Department of Education. Based on Act 82, public schools must submit an "Interscholastic Athletic Opportunities Disclosure Form" annually. We used data from 21 predominately white high schools. Among these schools, 18 of them have significant racial differences. The average for white athlete participation is 50% while the average for non-white groups is only 30%. In addition, 13 of these schools have significant gender differences for sport participation. The average male participation in sports is 50% while the average female participation is 41%. These findings raised an important question for high school sports: why do non-white athletes participate less than their white counterparts? And why do female athletes have lower participation rates? It's critical to understand what factors impact youth athlete decisions to participate in sports. This research has demonstrated the use of open records as a fundamental resource to assess racial and gender equality in high school. Although this study is limited to a small group of schools, we are continuing to expand our sample size. Our analysis offers educators insight about gender and racial disparities in sport participation which is fundamental to establish inclusion in youth sports.

Collegiate Athletics, Sexual Harassment, and Regulations: Do We Need a Broader Definition?

Zhou Zhang, Researcher, Hefei Athletics Association, Hefei Sports Bureau, Anhui, China

The abuses happened in Baylor University and the Larry Nassar scandal have brought sexual harassment in American collegiate athletics under the public scrutiny. Bitter debates on the legal conundrum and hurdles facing campus sexual misconduct cases also arises, in light of the regulation changes. The overarching question presented in this essay, is whether the mechanism and social context of collegiate athletics should be considered when enacting the laws against sexual harassment. This review uses secondary research and has examined both sociology works and law scholarship regarding college sport and sexual harassment. The study argues that, the two traits of college athletics calls for broader legal definition, in order to crack down the rampant sexual harassment in this field. It concludes that the narrower definition adopted by the newest regulation under Title IX, together with the lack of definition from NCAA, has created legal hurdles for combating this epidemic.

Educational Implications for Dancers as Athletes within Community and University Contexts: Examining Dancer Identity, Training Experiences, and Covid Impacts

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Victoria Dewar, Student, Master of Arts - Applied Health Sciences, Brock University, Ontario, Canada
Melissa Blackburn, Student, Master of Arts, Brock University, Ontario, Canada
Natalie Tacuri, Student, PhD in Educational Studies, McGill University, Quebec, Canada

This colloquium includes four papers examining youth dancers as athletes in community and university contexts. The first paper investigates relationships between dance participation, autonomy-supportive teaching, and dancer self-esteem among 425 competitive female youth dancers. Results indicate low and moderate levels of autonomy support from dance teachers predicted dancers experiencing lower levels of self-esteem as training hours increase. High levels of autonomy support showed no significant relationship between training hours and dancer self-esteem, indicating autonomy-supportive teaching may be a protective factor for dancers. The second paper compares training experiences among 425 dancers pre-covid and 232 dancers during covid. Important insights around training, dance engagement, and connections between dancers, teammates, and teachers will be discussed. The third paper focuses on similarities and differences amongst the experiences of competitive youth dancers across several styles. These adolescent community-based competitive dancers complete in styles such as jazz, lyrical, hip hop, Highland, and Irish. Across these styles, dancers have both related and varying studio experiences, levels of parental involvement, experiences at competitions, and attitudes around dance. The fourth paper examines competitive dancers' experiences in and outside of sport contexts in various universities. As competitive dance has varying levels of athletic status across universities, dancers' categorization and forms of representation are complicated as they occupy spaces as both artists and athletes. The symposium chair will lead a discussion on the implications from these studies around youth dancers' engagement in dance in various contexts, training insights, impacts on mental health and wellbeing, as well as dancer identity.

Parents from low-income families organizing sports participation for their children

Anne Annink, Researcher, sport and society, Utrecht School of Governance, Netherlands

Parents from low-income families experience several barriers in organizing sports participation for their children. Although municipal policies are focussed on offering support to alleviate the financial burden, for registration fees and outfits for example, parents indicate that they experience many more barriers. Examples are time constraints and difficulties with planning, multi-problems and other priorities, lack of transport and the route to the club being too long and unsafe. Furthermore, parents experience barriers to actually apply for financial support. In the Netherlands, municipal and private funds offer financial support for children aged 18 or below from families with 125% or less from minimum income. Parents indicate that they don't always know financial support is available or they feel ashamed to apply. When parents do apply, they find the procedures, which differ from city to city and from fund to fund, very complex. During the application procedures, which can be online or via an intermediary, parents often have to submit many documents and income data. Furthermore, yearly budgets are limited because of which not all registration costs are covered. Other costs for outfits, sports attributes, transport or Topsport fees are also not always covered. Lastly, not all sports clubs are affiliated with the clubs. Therefore, children from low-income families cannot participate at all sports clubs of their preference.

A Feminist Analysis of "Nike Women" Advertisements' Portrayal of the Female Athlete's Body

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The American transnational sports footwear and apparel giant, Nike, garners millions of views through its online 'Nike Women' advertising campaigns directed to female-identifying consumers. In this study, I draw on three such advertisements, namely, 'Dream Crazier', 'What are girls made of?' and 'The Toughest Athletes', to understand how capitalist mainstream media represents, and shapes common perceptions about, female-identified sportspersons and their bodies. The aforementioned advertisements have been hailed for breaking gender stereotypes, representing sportswomen from various marginalized social categories, challenging normative beauty standards, and "empowering" sportswomen. I, however, argue that a closer examination suggests otherwise. The language of meritocracy and agency used not only encourages sportswomen to embody capitalistic, masculine ideals but also blatantly overlooks the structural inequalities pertaining to race, sexuality, gender, religion, age, and disability that plague their lived experiences. Nike's portrayal of the female body (through its emphasis on extraordinariness, perseverance, and hyper-focus) merely replaces conventional feminine beauty standards with those of muscular and fit bodies that necessitate acute self-disciplining. Its portrayal of pregnant athletes' bodies in particular perpetuates toxic discourses that encourage women to perform "fit" and "healthy" pregnancies. My contention, therefore, is that contrary to popular belief, Nike merely typifies and reinforces a post-feminist sensibility that afflicts the contemporary popular imagination and reproduces normative gender binaries.

Autonomy, Sport, and Threat of Gender Violence

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Julie Baribault, Research Assistant, School of Social Sciences, Cape Breton University, Nova Scotia, Canada

Gender violence refers to a collection of harms and abuses enabled or sustained by systemic social practices, structures, and institutions and which target members of groups following gender lines inextricably linked to sexual orientation. Empirical studies are beginning to reveal sport participation as a place threatening gender violence outside the rules or conventions of play, including harassment and violence on the grounds of gender and sexual orientation. Within sport studies, attention to gender tends to focus on inequality and discrimination and less upon gender violence, while research on gender violence generally overlooks sport contexts, focussing primarily on threat of violence as fear and vigilance within rape culture. My analysis connects research on gender violence to sport contexts to reveal threat of violence as a serious constraint upon autonomy as options are either reduced or selectively navigated due to threat of harm. My account appeals to relational autonomy theory understanding autonomy as a site of development and progress influenced by and through our relations to others. On the relational view, autonomy is limited when social contexts undermine opportunities to cultivate and pursue options in practice. Through an examination of threat of violence within sport contexts, my analysis addresses harms to autonomy, drawing attention to limits and possibilities for developing and sustaining autonomy within contexts threatening violence. I maintain optimism that this investigation will illuminate compromised autonomy as a serious concern for those who aim to understand more deeply the effects of harmful sport contexts in the aim of countering associated harms.

The realization of inclusion for LGBTI+people in sport clubs

Inge Claringbould, Associate professor, School of governance, Utrecht University, Netherlands

Football club VV-ABIM (fictious name) intends to pay attention to creating a safer sports climate for LGBTQI+ players and wonders how to tackle this. The reason is that since the club has started with women's football, five years ago, there are some openly lesbian or bisexual women among them. These women are generally satisfied with the club, but are regularly disturbed by the homophobic or sexist comments from some men. Moreover, the National Sports Agreement pays a lot of attention to promoting a more positive and inclusive sports culture and all clubs have to pay attention to the agreement. There is a general agreement within the club that LGBTQI+ people are welcome and should feel safe, but some the board members realize that it may not yet be safe enough within the club. This is evidenced by the complaints of some women and the fact that not they do not know a single man who is out of the closet within the club. At the same time, there is resistance among some board members to taking specific measures for the safety of LGBTI+ people. They consider themselves quite inclusive and open to everyone. It is also believed that homophobic comments are made within the club, but that they are absolutely not intended to insult gays. Additionally, board members appear to be somewhat overworked by all the measures taken by municipalities and ministries to achieve inclusiveness and there is a lack of volunteers to carry out all these measures.

Who Really Won This Fight?: Hamia Chérif versus Hogan Bassey, Paris, 24 June 1957

Anene Ejikeme, Associate Professor, History, Trinity University, Texas, United States

In 1957 the Nigerian Hogan Bassey defeated the Algerian-born French subject Hamia Chérif to become the world featherweight champion. At the time of the fight, Nigeria was a British colony and Algeria's brutal war of independence was being fought. Typically, the war is presented as a battle between, on the one side, Algerians, represented by the Front National of Algeria (FLN), and on the other, France. However, there were many groups on both sides: war is complicated and this one was no exception. The key question I address in this work-in-progress is: Did Chérif "throw" the fight as some (now?) claim? To answer this central question, there are a number of critical questions that must be posed, including about the nature of the evidence. When did these rumors first begin to circulate? My paper also traces the complicated nature of each boxer's "national" identity.

Unlocking Purpose, Meaning, and Motivation through Embodiment and the Aesthetic Sport Experience

Elaine Foster, Clinical Assistant Professor, Human Performance and Sport Studies, Idaho State University, Idaho, United States
Sharon Stoll, Professor, Movement Sciences, University of Idaho, Idaho, United States

We discuss how whose body is considered highlights the objectification of humans in society. When viewed as an object or an it, bodies are things to be controlled, trained, shaped, and owned. As objects, athletes become a means to an end; to sell a product, provide entertainment, and to win. Alternatively, when people are understood as embodied beings who have subjective experiences, new meaning is born. An embodied perspective sees a body not as "...an object which [a human] possesses, rather it is [a human] and [a human] is [their] body" (Meier, 1979/1995, p. 91). Embodied athletes can experience the Aesthetic Sport Experience (ASE) or the inside, subjective experience of playing sports (Thomas, 1983). ASEs reveal purpose, meaning, and identity (Kretchmar, 2006). This presentation will challenge the objective view of athletes (whose body is it). Through dialogue with the presenters and exploration of their own experiences, participants will learn to (a) consider athletes as embodied beings, (b) recognize ASEs, and (c) promote subjective experiences as the purpose of sport.

Running is a Contact Sport

Lindsey Freeman, Associate Professor of Sociology, Sociology and Anthropology, Simon Fraser University, British Columbia, Canada

In the final stretch of the London Marathon in 1981, the Norwegian runner Inge Simonsen reaches for the American Dick Beardsley and catches hold of his hand; they run a few paces, break the tape, and raise their arms in elation. Then Simonsen ruffles Beardsley's hair. With these runners, we can see what the writer Joyce Carol Oates sees in boxing, "part dance, courtship and coupling." Watching them race, we witness autonomy sweetly dissolve into contact. In the post-race interview, Beardsley says that it was beautiful to win together, and possible because this was not the Olympics, where the runners would have had to compete for national glory. Athletes 'owe' nations in contests like the Olympics, which makes a finish like this impossible. Running is not typically thought of as a contact sport, where there is an emphasis on the physical, often brutal, meeting of competitors that you find in boxing, football, roller derby, or wrestling. When contact is considered in running, it is often as a foul or disaster, where one individual causes harm to another. In this paper, I consider what contact in sport could mean if we think of the coming together of bodies in a more tender way. I also challenge the convention in defining contact in sport as always violent. Thinking with sociological research and queer theory, along with my own embodied experiences as a runner and researcher, I explore how running touches us, by considering contact outside and alongside individual, national, and team perspectives.

Corruption in Sport: Citizens' Observatory in Colombia

Mauricio Hernandez, Director, Physical Education, Universidad de San Buenaventura, Antioquia, Colombia

The sport system can not reform itself, it needs the participation of civil society. On the one hand, corruption is a problem that can be viewed from different perspectives. On the other hand, sport as a social fact is full of meanings and value for governments, corporations, and the transnational non-governmental organizations that promote it, such as the International Olympic Committee and FIFA. When both phenomena are analyzed, new fields of the study appear, education and training needs are identified in sports organizations, and opportunities are created for anyone interested in the sports integrity industry. This paper presents the results of the Corruption in Sport Observatory in Colombia, three successful models in the fight against corruption in Latin America, which have served as a case study, which can be exported to the world, and adopted into the sport system. The results are classified into five areas: governability, transparency, funding, political campaigns, and international cooperation. The Corruption in Sport Observatory is a branch of the Summit of the Americas.

Gender Games: Sports and the Gender Binary

Tanya Kini, Community Manager, Communications, She Sports Switzerland, Karnataka, India

Sport has been a space for political expression and advocacy. Athletes and governments have used the international sport system to push their political agenda, successfully or not. The International Olympic Committee has however maintained its apolitical stance, even within a 21st century society calling for better protections of human rights. This paper, as an extract of the author's Master's thesis, through academic literature reviewed in sports studies and gender theories, uses three research questions to explain the IOC's reluctance to take charge of protecting LGBTQ+ rights in sport. It also includes semi-structured interviews of relevant experts and a content analysis of online news media. Findings showcase the need for a thorough understanding of gender and sexuality before attempting to rebuild the gender binary in sport. An acknowledgement of LGBTQ+ rights as human rights and their protection especially within sport is necessary. Future research should explore pathways to make the international sport system a better protector of human rights.

Moving with Identity and World-building in Early Childhood Education and Child and Youth Care

Nicole Land, Assistant Professor, Early Childhood Studies, Ryerson University, Ontario, Canada
Shemine Gulamhusein, Assistant Professor, Child and Youth Care, MacEwan University, Canada

Amid fields - postdevelopmental early childhood pedagogies and radical child and youth care - that resist the image of the rational, individualized subject grounded in humanism and endemic of anthropocentrism, we take the intersections of autonomy, movement, sport, physical education, and identity as a space of collective experimentation toward living well together with young people. Children and youth are re-creating body narratives and curricula beyond the bounded self, cracking the individualist legacies of autonomy. In our ongoing research, we take seriously how children and youth are inventing immersive acts of moving as identity and world-building. Within Nicole's project, a collaborative action research project with toddlers and preschoolers in an early childhood education classroom, we ask "how do we get to know moving" and find that moving unfolds alongside identity, where to move is an activity that produces situated moving cultures that demand localized pedagogical responses. In Shemine's community-engaged research project with immigrants and refugees, we further our understanding of how community leaders lean on recreational pursuits to overcome systemic oppression, pre- and post- migration trauma, and in-between identities. Taken together, our research grapples with questions of autonomy and movement amid education and recreation contexts, following how identity becomes intertwined with moving and sporting cultures anchored in a commons that disrupts inherited conceptions of individualized human autonomy, and draws us toward rethinking identity amid the rich ethical and political swirls that animate movement and bodies.

A Female Athlete's Model for Autonomy through Connection

Heidi Muller, Professor, Communication and Journalism, University of Northern Colorado, Colorado, United States

I vividly remember being asked the unexpected question as a pre-teen: "Do you want to be a boy." I was used to being "buzzed" into the boy's bathroom when wearing my Little League cap in Kmart and having to explain that I needed the other bathroom, but still, my experience of the question was confusion, for why would someone ask me if I wanted to be something I am not? This question is just part of the range of experiences that for some athletes, including me, make up the web of impact that either supports or impinges on my autonomy–on my ability to be the person making the decisions of import in my athletic life. As a communication theorist and discourse analyst employing PERPLE methodology, this paper presents a practically theoretical model (initially explored in other writing and deeply rooted in talk around my own lived experience) as one guide for how I, and potentially others, can "do" being the best athlete one can be. The model centers on positivity and includes 1) the parallel tracks of engaged training and creative engagement 2) empowered decision-making, 3) me-in-team identity, and 4) sports as strategic art. In addition to the core of positivity, central to the model is the realization that being an athlete is accomplished through connection. Suggestions are provided for employing this model to facilitate athletes in embracing the reality of connection in sports as a means to find voice, agency, and autonomy on the never-ending, ever-present, can-do level.

The Role of Individual Autonomy in the Co-Construction of Team Identity

Lauren Pierce, Assistant Professor, Educational Psychology, Northern State University, South Dakota, United States

It is a well-known fact that individual autonomy is essential in self-regulatory behavior and motivation. However, it is lesser known how individuals leverage their autonomy within groups to create, advocate, and consolidate team culture and identity. This study follows four teams of volleyball players within a single club as they navigate the complexity of forging group identity. We aim to further understand the role of individual autonomy in the sport-specific creation of team and club culture through a co-regulation framework that explores the unique roles of the individual, social, and cultural constructs in emergent identity formation. Athletes were given a survey analyzing motivation and identity at three different points during the season. Extensive field notes at games, team meetings, and practices were applied to theoretical coding systems to add group context to the athlete's individual responses. This study illustrates the importance of the individual athlete's role in capitalizing on existing moments of tension that the team must navigate together as they continuously redefine their identity in the face of new and unique challenges. Research found that there are both adaptive and maladaptive ways that individual autonomy can be used to leverage tension for productive group affects. This work illustrates that a sense of individual autonomy is essential in fostering adaptive group tension during the season. The resulting tension can be utilized to reaffirm essential aspects of identity as teams confront new challenges. Coaches and players should embrace autonomous behavior to foster growth in existing team sociocultural structures throughout the season.

From Nichomachean to Cyborgean - the Un-Bio-Ethical Dimension of the Olympics and Paralympics: Bioethical Concerns Regarding Respect for Autonomy and Power Dynamics among the Doctor/Coach/Athlete Triad in Pursuit of Human Performance

Constantine Psimopoulos, Student, Master of Bioethics, Harvard Medical School, Massachusetts, United States

The essence of the Paralympics is "the pursuit of human excellence through the dedicated perfection of each person's natural talents". In the realm of health, disability, law and bioethics, scholars have sought to explore the impact that disability has on legal, medical and social structures, and with the Paralympics being a socially structured phenomenon it is fair play for such applications of scholarly endeavor. Can body alternations ever be justified? Does society accept bodies that are more than just biological? Accepting that cheating is fundamentally contrary to that spirit of sport, then why is it that those Olympic rings are tarnished by a plethora of negative examples and un-sports-person-like behaviors which permeate the very fabric of Paralympic sport, while society blatantly ignores all these un-ethical challenges in the sacrificial temple of spectacle, record breaking and revenue making broadcasting marvels pursuant to the need for a creation of modern day heroes?

A Black Feminist Political Economy of Sport in Higher Education

Rachel Roberson, Student, PhD, University of California, Berkeley, United States

This study, grounded in Wynter's perspective of the Human (1994, 1997), evaluates the policies and practices that create and maintain the stratification of power and bodily labor within intercollegiate athletic departments. I build upon the foundation laid by critical higher education scholars (Boggs & Mitchell, 2018; Dancy, Edwards, & Davis, 2018; Mustaffa, 2017; Stein, 2016) who argue that the foundation of American higher education is intrinsically linked to anti-Blackness; thus maintaining the stratification of power upheld by the value of Whiteness. This structural analysis pays particular attention to disentangling the intersectional nuance of Black male bodily labor and White women's accrual of capital. White women in sport play the role of 'Border Beckys' (Ignatiev & Garvey, 2014), wherein their proximity to people of color provides an awareness to difference and results in a desire to separate themselves from the system of oppression that impacts the POC community, however their actions provide insight into the difficulty in dismantling and resisting a system they continuously benefit from. Ultimately, this work builds upon a legacy of Whiteness as property (Harris, 1993; Haney-Lopez, 1996). I add to our understanding of the valuing and devaluing of Black bodies within society at large, emphasizing our historical dehumanization through labor exploitation and domestication. It is my hope this paper help combat the revisionist history (Stein, 2016) of wielding Whiteness within the institution of sport and the neoliberal university.

Commodifying Athletes' Bodies: A Three Millennium Journey

Tom Roberts, Senior Lecturer, Department of History, Philosophy & Social Sciences, Rhode Island School of Design, Rhode Island, United States

For three and a half millennia, the symmetry of athletes' bodies has inspired cultural ideals and simultaneously spurred commercial exploitation. I will trace the progression of the athlete's body from its cultural and commercial power in the ancient world to our modern concept of exploitation, now more frequently managed by the athletes themselves. Along the way, athletes' bodies were either vilified (in the Middle Ages) or eroticized (in the early 20th century and beyond) almost always for the benefit of some cause other than the athletes' pursuit of excellence in their sport. Accomplished athletes such as Annette Kellerman, Johnny Weissmuller and Katarina Witt – among many others – found lucrative post-sports careers in objectified erotic displays of their physical allure. Inevitably, dark-skinned athletes were largely excluded from this. Yet, through their own initiative and determination, athletes such as Muhammad Ali, Arthur Ashe and Paul Robeson translated their athletic prowess into powerful political and cultural presences in the world arena. Racial classification has become more subtle and athlete control more common, yet the commodification continues.

Athletes' voice in elite sports policy's outputs and outcomes

Jan Willem van der Roest, Assistant Professor, Utrecht University, Netherlands

The Netherlands are a country that is able to compete in elite sports at the highest levels. When world championships and Olympic and Paralympic medals are considered, the Netherlands have been among the twenty best sporting nations of the world for more than a decade (Gracenote, NOC*NSF, 2020). At recent Olympic Games, the country even reached a top-ten position. These accomplishments are the result of carefully planned national strategic approaches (Van der Roest, De Bosscher & Shibli, 2022). Although this systemic approach might be successful, its legitimacy is increasingly being questioned in public debates. The one-sidedness of aiming at medal-winning success at global events is becoming problematic. Moreover, there is a discourse shift apparent from the above outlined focus on outputs (e.g. global medal-winning success) towards an orientation on outcomes (the societal value of sport, such as building national identity or asking attention for climate change) that can also be observed in other nations. However, two problems can be observed in these debates. First, athletes have never been included in determining what objectives should be included on the output level. After all, athletic performances can be defined more broadly than just focusing on global medals. Second, athletes voices are also not included in the shift from output orientation towards outcome orientation. Yet, for the policy to be effective, one could argue that athletes' voices are crucial in this respect.

Why Otherly has Meaning and Power

Aubrey Shaw, Research Consultant for the Center for ETHICS, University of Idaho, Idaho, United States
Sharon Stoll, Professor, Movement Sciences, University of Idaho, Idaho, United States

Michael Oliver in, What is so wonderful about walking? makes a compelling argument of how walking is a societal symbol of the abled bodied. He also argues that ableness should not be linked to walking. However, Oliver's point is lost since society does judge a person's physical ability by their walking or lack thereof. Oliver quotes poet Lois Keith, that just because she cannot stand does not make her weak; rather she is "otherly". Keith also asks: whose body is it and who decides the worth of that body? Even though she must often depend on other human beings, she is capable. Abled individuals often demean the power and ability of individuals who are otherly, including the para-abled. Historically, people who are otherly have always been treated poorly. In ancient times those who were physically different were left to die. From time immortal, language described these individuals as crippled, or worse. Little thought was given to the meaningfulness of language, including the word disability. Aimee Mullins, a United States Paralympian, in her 2009 TED talk, discusses that words have meaning. The words we choose describe what we value and believe. Often when we use words to describe others those words are inadequate and therefore, often belittle and defame. Consider the word disabled. Synonyms are handicapped, wrecked, ruined, lame, and crippled. The purpose of this study is twofold: 1) Discuss the relationship between words and the body; and 2) Consider the effect of words demeaning the body of the otherly.

Can an Athlete's Voice Help Improve the Anti-doping System?

Richard Vaughan, PhD Student, Sport, University of Canberra, Australia

The sports sector has been under scrutiny for some time due to individual and systematic cheating to unfairly profit from doping (Dimeo, and Moller, 2018; Ordway, and Opie 2017; Wilson et al, 2016, Henning, and Dimeo, 2018; Gatterer et al, 2021). This research builds on and expands a range of work in the integrity sector using the athlete voice to gain theoretical understanding with two core goals. The first intends to examine 'athletes' experiences in the anti-doping system, managed by World Anti-Doping Authority Program (WADA). The data from the athletes these insights is then analysed to form themes that can be used to better understand how we can improve all components of the anti-doping system. By doing this we aim to build on current areas of exploration in the anti-doping field. Work by Moller, and Christiansen (2022); and Shelley, Thrower, and Petroczi (2021) provide a plethora of areas that need to be better understood. The second goal is to us these insights to help SIA improve their policies, procedures, and resources from education through to the results management process. The research will use a qualitative athlete survey which will be disseminated by the National Anti-Doping Organisation (NADO). Australian athletes and Sport Integrity Australia (SIA), the Australian NADO, will provide the source of the data, with athlete surveys in line with previous WADA surveys ad work by Donovan, Jalleh, and Gucciardi (2018).

The Role of Leadership and Team Culture in Enhancing Sport Performance Outcomes

Jennifer Walinga, Professor, School of Communication and Culture, Royal Roads University, British Columbia, Canada
Danielle Cyr, Student, Doctor of Social Sciences, Royal Roads University, British Columbia, Canada

We reviewed the experience of eleven women rowers who reached their peak performance winning multiple gold medals across multiple events and boat classes in the 1992 Olympics. The case study, based on interviews, group discussions, and participant observation, reviewed their development from 1988 to 1992 and identified non-hierarchical values, structures, and environments as integral to their performance. Our research builds on Edgar Schein's organizational culture model, which asserts that fundamental assumptions underlie governing values and beliefs that manifest in various cultural organizational artifacts, such as leadership practices, team process, structures, mechanisms, and routines. The study discusses the interaction of coach and athlete roles with both roles being agents in cultural development.

Sport Clubs and the Future of Activism: A Scoping Review Highlighting How Sport Clubs Are Embracing a New Role

Eva Wolzok, Student, PhD, National Taiwan Normal University, Taiwan

This study explores the ways in which sport clubs engage with activism. With globalisation and an increasingly connected world, the phenomenon of activism through sport is growing rapidly. There have been comprehensive analyses of sporting figures such as Billie Jean King, Megan Rapinoe, Serena Williams, Colin Kaepernick, Lewis Hamilton or the Norwegian women's volleyball team in terms of their own activism with a view to improve not only their sport but to affect long-lasting social change. While a rise has been seen in research concerning individual sporting figures and activism, the area of sporting institutions and activism remains largely unexplored. Given the impact of the activism and advocacy of individual sporting figures, this paper posits that sports clubs and sporting institutions may hold further potential as a way to achieve sustainable positive change within their own communities. With the prospective of greater connectivity and a wider reach, sporting institutions may be posited as role models for broader, systemic social change. Through a scoping review, comprising of both academic journals and grey literature, identification of this new phenomenon is explored. By using a scoping review, it enables a high volume of information to be synthesised, providing an overview of what has been investigated thus far and therefore giving direction to future research. This research aims to answer the following questions: "Who are the sport clubs leading activism?"; "What are the types of activism they carry out?"; and "How have they been discussed in 'the literature' thus far?".

Attendance List

Adonis Abdullah, UNC Charlotte, United States
Allai Abou-Chaker
Ciaran Acton, Ulster University, United Kingdom
Mike Nana Agyei Danchie, Ghana Denmark Friendship Association/Intersports and Culture Association -Ghana
James Allen, Presbyterian College, United States
Jesper Andreasson, Lnu, Sweden
Anne Annink, Utrecht School of Governance, Netherlands
Sajusha Ashok, IIT Madras, India
Christopher Atwater, Troy University, United States
Nadina Ayer, Bournemouth University, United Kingdom
Julie Baribault, Cape Breton University, Canada
William Bartley, Transylvania University, United States
Astrid Becker-Larsen, Aarhus University, Denmark
Melissa Blackburn, Brock University, Canada
Claire Boczkowski, Bayard Rustin High School, United States
Semassa Boko, University of California Irvine, United States
Jules Boykoff, Pacific University, United States
Mads Brix Baulund, DIF Athletes Committee, Denmark
Greg Broekemier, University of Nebraska at Kearney, United States
Bernardo Buarque De Hollanda, Fundação Getulio Vargas, Brazil
Brooke Carlson, University of Nebraska Kearney, United States
Cary Caro, Xavier University of Louisiana,
Tiara A Cash, Simon Fraser University, Canada
Marilyn Castro, University of California, Santa Barbara, United States
Wenyi Chang, National Taiwan Normal University, Taiwan
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Inge Claringbould, Utrecht University, Netherlands
Brent Clark Jr, UC Irvine, United States
Zachary Consitt, York University, Canada
Devorah Curtis, Saybrook University, United States
Danielle Cyr, Royal Roads University, Canada
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Angie Fan, Simon Fraser University, Canada
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Elaine Foster, Idaho State University, United States
Lindsey Freeman, Simon Fraser University, Canada
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Victoria Harms, Johns Hopkins University, United States
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Michael Insler, United States Naval Academy, United States
Martin Johansen, Southern University of Denmark, Denmark
Matthias Kaelberer, University of Memphis, United States
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Daniel Kilvington, Leeds Beckett University, United Kingdom
Tanya Kini, She Sports Switzerland, India
Arne Koch, Colby College, United States
Rob Koehler, Global Athlete, United States
Amanda Kraus, University of Arizona, United States
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Simon Lonbro, Aarhus University,
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Common Ground Research Networks

COMMON GROUND

Founded in 1984, Common Ground is committed to building new kinds of knowledge communities, innovative in their media, and forward-thinking in their messages. Heritage knowledge systems are characterized by vertical separations--of discipline, professional association, institution, and country. Common Ground Research Networks takes some of the pivotal challenges of our time and curates research networks that cut horizontally across legacy knowledge structures. Sustainability, diversity, learning, the future of humanities, the nature of interdisciplinarity, the place of the arts in society, technology's connections with knowledge--these are deeply important questions of our time that require interdisciplinary thinking, global conversations, and cross-institutional intellectual collaborations.

Common Ground Research Networks are meeting places for people, ideas, and dialogue. However, the strength of ideas does not come from finding common denominators. Rather, the power and resilience of these ideas is that they are presented and tested in a shared space where differences can meet and safely connect--differences of perspective, experience, knowledge base, methodology, geographical or cultural origins, and institutional affiliation. These are the kinds of vigorous and sympathetic academic milieus in which the most productive deliberations about the future can be held. We strive to create places of intellectual interaction and imagination that our future deserves.

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COMMON GROUND MEDIA LAB

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ILLINOIS RESEARCH PARK

The Common Ground Media Lab is the research and technology arm of Common Ground Research Networks. Common Ground Research Networks has been researching knowledge ecologies and building scholarly communication technologies since 1984.

Since 2009, we have had the fortune of being based in the University of Illinois Research Park while building our latest platform – CGScholar. This is a suite of apps based on the theoretical work of world-renowned scholars from the College of Education and Department of Computer Science at the University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign. CGScholar has been built with the support of funding from the US Department of Education, Illinois Ventures, and the Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation.

The CGScholar platform is being used today by knowledge workers as diverse as: faculty in universities to deliver e-learning experiences; innovative schools wishing to challenge the ways learning and assessment have traditionally worked; and government and non-government organizations connecting local knowledge and experience to wider policy objectives and measurable outcomes. Each of these use cases illustrates the differing of knowledge that CGScholar serves while also opening spaces for new and emerging voices in the world of scholarly communication.

We aim to synthesize these use cases to build a platform that can become a trusted marketplace for knowledge work, one that rigorously democratizes the process of knowledge-making, rewards participants, and offers a secure basis for the sustainable creation and distribution of digital knowledge artifacts.

Our premise has been that media platforms–pre-digital and now also digital–have often not been designed to structure and facilitate a rigorous, democratic, and a sustainable knowledge economy. The Common Ground Media Lab seeks to leverage our own platform – CGScholar – to explore alternatives based on extended dialogue, reflexive feedback, and formal knowledge ontologies. We are developing AI-informed measures of knowledge artifacts, knowledge actors, and digital knowledge communities. We aim to build a trusted marketplace for knowledge work, that rewards participants and sustains knowledge production.

With 27,000 published works and 200,000 users, we have come a long way since our first web app twenty years ago. But we still only see this as the beginning.

As a not-for-profit, we are fundamentally guided by mission: to support the building of better societies and informed citizenries through rigorous and inclusive social knowledge practices, offering in-person and online scholarly communication spaces

Supporters & Partners

As they say, "it takes a village." We are thankful for the generous support of:

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And to our Research Network members!

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COMMON GROUND

United Nations
Climate Change

CLIMATE NEUTRAL NOW

Climate change is one of the most pressing problems facing our world today. It is in the interests of everyone that we engage in systemic change that averts climate catastrophe. At Common Ground Research Networks, we are committed to playing our part as an agent of transformation, promoting awareness, and making every attempt to lead by example. Our Climate Change: Impacts and Responses Research Network has been a forum for sharing critical findings and engaging scientific, theoretical, and practical issues that are raised by the realities of climate change. We've been a part of global policy debates as official observers at COP26 in Glasgow. And we are signatories of the United Nations Sustainability Publishers Compact and the United Nations Climate Neutral Now Initiative.

Measuring

In 2022 we start the process of tracking and measuring emissions for all aspects of what we do. The aim is to build a comprehensive picture of our baselines to identify areas where emissions can be reduced and construct a long-term plan of action based on the GHG Emissions Calculation Tool and standard established by the United Nations Climate Neutral Now Initiative.

Reducing

At the same time, we are not waiting to act. Here are some of the "low hanging fruit" initiatives we are moving on immediately: all conference programs from print to electronic-only; removing single-use cups and offering reusable bottles at all our conferences; working closely with all vendors, suppliers, and distributors on how we can work together to reduce waste; offering robust online options as a pathway to minimize travel. And this is only a small sample of what we'll be doing in the short term.

Contributing

As we work towards establishing and setting net-zero targets by 2050, as enshrined in the Paris Agreement and United Nations Climate Neutral Now Initiative, and to make further inroads in mitigating our impacts today, we are participating in the United Nations Carbon Offset program. As we see climate change as having broad social, economic, and political consequences, we are investing in the following projects.

- Fiji Nadarivatu Hydropower Project
- DelAgua Public Health Program in Eastern Africa
- Jangi Wind Farm in Gujarat

Long Term Goals

We're committing to long-term science-based net-zero targets for our operations – and we believe we can do this much sooner than 2050. We'll be reporting annually via The Climate Neutral Now reporting mechanism to transparently communicate how we are meeting our commitments to climate action.

www.cgnetworks.org/about/climate-pledge

Proceedings of the Thirteenth International Conference on Sport & Society, 30 June – 1 July 2022. The conference featured research addressing the following special focus: "Whose Body Is it? Sport and the Problem of Autonomy" and annual themes:

- Sporting Cultures and Identities
- Sport and Health
- Sports Education
- Sports Management and Commercialization

